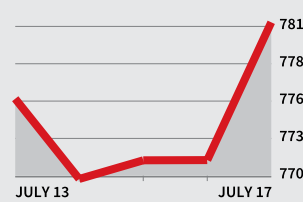


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78151.45 (+964.58)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24334.30	+261.55
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.18	+0.25
US Dollar (in ₹)	96.28	-0.06
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	140594.00	-518
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	215474.00	-1960

EMISSION RACE.

CAFE-III benefits automakers with diverse fuel options; Renault and Nissan may need carbon credits to comply **p2**



AUTO FOCUS.

Tata Sierra.ev delivers comfort, performance and refinement with everyday usability **p4**

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QUICKLY.

RURAL EXPANSION

Banking services must reach every village: FM



Hyderabad: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday said the Centre's objective was to ensure the reach of banking services across every village and facilitate easier access for small entrepreneurs to institutional credit. Speaking at a mega credit outreach programme at Narasaraopet in Andhra Pradesh, Sitharaman said public sector banks were increasingly reaching out to entrepreneurs and extending loans at their doorstep. **p3**

SUPPLY CRUNCH

Pfizer confirms temporary suspension of Premarin

Mumbai: Multinational drugmaker Pfizer confirmed that it had suspended its Premarin brand of cream in India, adding that it was looking to restore supplies. "We wish to submit that Premarin vaginal cream, which is an imported product, has been temporarily discontinued in India due to certain supply constraints," Pfizer told the BSE, without giving details of the reason for the shortage. **p9**

Reliance Ind revenue jumps 25% in Q1 led by O2C and Jio

MIXED BAG. Net drops 22% on effect of one-time gain last year; EBITDA at record ₹47,517 cr

Amit Vijay Mohile
Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Reliance Industries reported a robust set of Q1 FY27 earnings, with strong performances from its oil-to-chemicals (O2C) and telecom businesses helping it surpass street expectations. While reported profit declined due to a high base from a one-time gain last year, recurring profitability reached a record level.

Profit fell 22.4 per cent year-on-year to ₹20,946 crore, largely because Q1 FY26 included a one-time gain from the sale of the company's stake in Asian Paints. Excluding ₹8,924 crore from Asian Paints gains, the profit for Q1FY27 could have been 16 per cent higher. Higher finance costs and depreciation charges also weighed on the bottomline.

RECORD PAT

However, on a recurring basis, profit after tax before minority interests rose 6.1 per cent to an all-time high of ₹23,196 crore from an adjusted ₹21,859 crore a year ago. The reported profit figure

Scorecard

	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	y-o-y % change
Revenue	2,48,660	3,11,850	25.4
EBITDA	42,905	47,517	10.7
Net profit	26,994	20,946	-22.4
EBITDA margin (%)	17.3	15.2	-
Net profit margin (%)	10.9	6.7	-

was ahead of *Bloomberg's* consensus estimate of ₹19,987 crore.

Mukesh Ambani, Chairman and Managing Director, said, "Reliance has made a steady start to FY27, with all businesses delivering strong operating performance even as the company witnessed continuing geopolitical tensions and volatile commodity markets."

Gross revenue increased 24.5 per cent y-o-y to ₹3.4 lakh crore, while EBITDA rose 10.7 per cent to a record ₹47,517 crore. Revenue from operations climbed 25.4 per cent to ₹3,11,850 crore from ₹2,48,660 crore in the corresponding quarter last year, exceeding *Bloomberg's* estimate of ₹2,98,716 crore. Recurring EBITDA also surpassed analysts' forecast of ₹46,660 crore.

"Strong O2C margins and

resilient Jio growth powered Reliance's quarter, offsetting weakness in retail and lingering pressure in the upstream business," said Maulik Patel, Head of Research at Equirus Securities.

O2C RECOVERY

The O2C segment delivered one of its strongest quarters in recent years. Revenue surged 30.4 per cent to ₹2,01,803 crore from ₹1,54,804 crore in Q1 FY26, while EBITDA rose 17.2 per cent to ₹17,010 crore from ₹14,511 crore. The improvement was driven by a sharp recovery in fuel cracks, which increased 2.5 to 4.5 times y-o-y, along with downstream chemical margins reaching three-to-four-year highs. These gains more than offset lower production resulting from a planned maintenance turnaround.

Jio continued to execute well with subscriber additions, modest ARPU improvement and record-high EBITDA margins, reaffirming strength of its telecom franchise. EBITDA grew 15.1 per cent to ₹20,865 crore, with EBITDA margins expanding by 150 basis points to 53.3 per cent from 51.8 per cent.

Digital services revenue grew 20 per cent y-o-y, significantly ahead of the 11 per cent growth in connectivity services. Growth was driven by content, cloud computing, Internet of Things and managed services, highlighting Jio's diversification beyond traditional telecom operations. Average revenue per user increased to ₹215.6 from ₹208.8 in the year-ago quarter.

Retail remained a key weak spot, with margin compressing to a 15-quarter low amid investments in scaling digital commerce. Reliance Retail posted revenue of ₹90,408 crore, up 7.4 per cent from Q1 FY26. However, EBITDA slipped marginally to ₹6,309 crore with margins contracting 80 basis points to 7.9 per cent from 8.7 per cent.

More reports on p2

FPIs exited, but foreign promoters raised stake in Nifty-500 firms in FY26

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

Even as FPIs net sold ₹1.80 lakh crore of Indian equities in FY26, foreign promoters seem to have shown more faith in the Indian stock market.

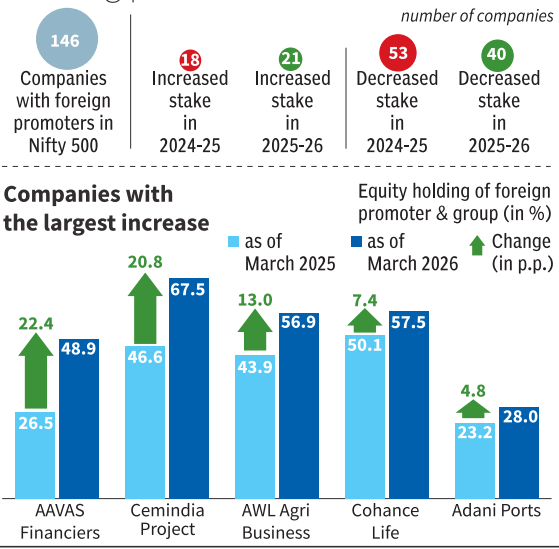
A *businessline* analysis of Capitaline data shows that of the 146 companies in Nifty-500 with foreign promoter holdings, 40 companies, or 27.4 per cent, saw a reduction in foreign promoter stake in FY26 compared with 53 companies (36.3 per cent) in FY25. At the same time, the number of companies witnessing an increase in foreign promoter holdings rose to 21 from 18 a year earlier.

FOREIGN INFLOW

Increase in foreign promoter stake in FY26 was concentrated in a handful of companies. AAVAS Financiers registered the largest increase at 22.41 percentage points, as Aquilo House bought a stake from Lake District Holdings and Partners Group.

Cemindia Project, an infrastructure developer and operator, followed closely with an increase of 20.82 percentage points. Adani Ports also saw foreign promoter holdings rise by 4.79 percentage points to 28.03 per cent. AWL Agri Business at-

Holding pattern



Source: *BI analysis*, Capitaline

tracted a further 13 percentage points of foreign promoter investment, while Cohance Life recorded a 7.39 percentage-point increase.

BIGGEST EXITS

Only 5 companies have seen foreign promoters reduce their holdings by more than 10 per cent in FY26. Twenty companies have seen a marginal reduction at less than one per cent.

The sharpest reduction was seen in JSW Dulux, where Imperial Chemical and Akzo Nobel Coatings completely exited their combined 74.76 per cent holding

by March 2026. Berger Paints also saw a complete exit of foreign promoter holdings.

Aptus Value Housing Finance recorded the second-largest decline, with foreign promoter ownership dropping 28.59 percentage points, with the exit of Westbridge Crossover Fund and JIH II. Anu Anand Ravilla continues to hold a 1.03 per cent stake in the company as of March 2026.

Whirlpool India and KFin Technologies also saw a notable decline, with holdings falling by 11.24 percentage points and 10.05 percentage points respectively.

India's steel exporters unhappy as UK quotas falling short in key categories can choke shipments

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The duty-free quota for steel exports to the UK secured by India falls short in several key product categories, with exporters warning that limits can get exhausted quickly and choke shipments.

While the country-specific and residual tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) negotiated by India improve on the UK's earlier safeguard regime, which took effect on July 1, industry representatives say the allocations remain inadequate for products where India already has a strong export presence.

"It doesn't matter what the overall quota is if there isn't enough allocation in categories where Indian industry has considerable ongoing exports. Exporters



Allocations in certain categories remain too tight to accommodate existing trade volumes, say exporters **p11**

would want quotas equivalent to at least the average of their last three years of exports. India must urge the British government to enhance quotas in the categories that matter most or exports will decline," said Pankaj Chadha, Chairman, Engineering Exports Promotion Council of India.

The UK's announcement of new steel safeguard meas-

ures earlier this year, involving deep cuts to duty-free import quotas from July 1, prompted India to delay the finalisation of the India-UK CETA.

The impasse was resolved before the agreement took effect on July 15, with India securing higher quotas, access to the UK's residual quota and exemptions for some product lines. Even so, exporters say allocations in certain categories remain too tight to accommodate existing trade volumes.

TARIFF TRIGGER

The EEPC has identified six product categories where export volumes already exceed the UK's duty-free quotas, risking quota exhaustion and exposure to the 50 per cent out-of-quota tariff.

These include non-alloy and other alloy hot-rolled

sheets and strips (category 1), stainless bars and light sections (category 14), stainless wire rod (category 15), non-alloy merchant bars and light sections (category 12B), gas pipes (category 20) and other welded tubes (category 26).

Viraj Profiles Managing Director Rakesh Chauhan said the company was "surprised" that under the UK's revised notification of July 2, the annual residual quotas for categories 14 and 15 stayed unchanged even as the EU's quotas were increased.

"The issue is that India does not have a dedicated country-specific quota in categories 14 and 15. Exporters are competing with other non-EU and non-US suppliers for the residual quota on a first-come, first-served basis," Chauhan said.

HYDROGEN POWER



IN SELECT CLUB. Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagging off India's first hydrogen-powered train at Jind railway station, Haryana. It will run up to Sonipat. With this, India has joined a select group of countries that have operational hydrogen-powered trains. It marks an important step towards the adoption of clean and sustainable mobility in the railway sector. The 89-km distance between Jind and Sonipat will be covered in two hours, with the train halting at 12 intermediate stations **Report on p9 p11**

As *mithai* finds a sweet spot globally, exports surge 10%

Rising overseas appetite boosts exports, innovation and investments across industry

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

The world is developing a sweet tooth for Indian mithai. India's ₹1.5 lakh crore *mithai* and *namkeen* market is no longer just a festive domestic indulgence but is garnering significant global traction. And consumption is rapidly expanding beyond the Indian diaspora to foreign populations.

"About 10 per cent of Indian sweets and *namkeen* are exported, with shipments growing at over 10 per cent annually," Feroz H Naqvi, Director-General, Federation of Sweets and Namkeen Manufacturers (FSNM), told *businessline* on the sidelines of the World Mithai and Namkeen Convention (WMNC) Purchasing 2026.

"Indian *gulab jamun* is



MOUTHWATERING TREATS. Visitors at the World Mithai and Namkeen Convention Purchasing 2026 in Hyderabad

now among the most popular desserts in the United Kingdom, while demand is also increasing in South-East Asian countries," Naqvi said.

SUGAR RUSH

Even consumers in Europe, where chocolate-based confectionery dominates the dessert market, are developing a taste for Indian

sweets. Besides *gulab jamun*, *rasgulla*, *soan papdi* and *Mysore pak* are making their way onto dessert menus overseas.

The trend has enthused established manufacturers. "We have been exporting sweets for many decades, but demand has increased considerably of late," said Neeraj Agarwal, Director, Haldiram's. The Nagpur-

based sweets and *namkeen* company exports its products to the US, Canada, Singapore, Japan, and South-East Asian markets, among others.

According to Agarwal, improvements in shelf-life and packaging have helped the industry overcome two of its principal export challenges.

Advanced technology-based packaging is enabling companies to preserve product quality for longer periods and reach distant markets.

CAPACITY EXPANSION

Rising demand is also prompting companies to create dedicated production infrastructure. Hyderabad-based Dadu Mithai Vatika is setting up an exclusive export kitchen in the city. The facility, expected to be commissioned shortly,

will undertake large-scale production of *motichoor laddus* for the overseas markets, according to its Managing Director, Rajesh Dadu.

The Hyderabad-based Dadu is also experimenting with chocolate-based sweets and dry-fruit combinations, which are gaining popularity in the Gulf countries, the US and Europe.

Ahead of the festival season, the WMNC Purchasing 2026 event brought together manufacturers, retailers, suppliers and technology providers from the *mithai*, *namkeen*, bakery and allied food sectors.

The event saw intense discussions on the industry's supply chain — from raw materials, dry fruits and ingredients to processing machinery, packaging, automation and gifting solutions.

China's Moonshot unveils world's largest open-weight AI model Kimi K3

Reuters
Beijing

Chinese AI start-up Moonshot on Friday unveiled Kimi K3, a 2.8 trillion-parameter model that it said is the world's largest open-weight AI system and delivers performance approaching US giant Anthropic's frontier Fable model.

The launch, which comes a month after Anthropic's Fable and Mythos models were abruptly withdrawn by the US government due to security concerns, underscores how quickly China's open AI ecosystem is narrowing the gap with the most advanced US systems.

REASONING LEAP

Companies including Moonshot, Z.ai and MiniMax are releasing increasingly powerful models at sharply lower costs, challenging long-held assumptions in



The Moonshot booth at the World Artificial Intelligence Conference in Shanghai **REUTERS**

the West that Chinese developers trail their American peers by months.

Moonshot said Kimi K3 is the first open-weight model to approach the 3 trillion-parameter mark and is designed for advanced reasoning, long-horizon coding and knowledge work. The model features a 1 million-token context window, allowing it to process and retain substantially more information than earlier generations in a single prompt.

Kimi K3 "performed com-

petitively with Fable 5 (with fallback) and substantially outperformed Anthropic's Opus 4.8, GPT 5.6 Sol, and GPT 5.5" in terms of GPU kernel optimisation, the company said. The term refers to techniques that maximise AI hardware utilisation and minimise latency. The model has also posted strong results in third-party evaluations.

COMPLEX TASKS

Artificial Analysis said the model delivered performance comparable to OpenAI's GPT-5.5 and Anthropic's Claude Opus 4.8, on tests measuring complex, multi-step tasks.

The Moonshot news drove shares of Chinese AI competitors Zhipu and Minimax down sharply in Hong Kong; just before market close, they were down 27.7 per cent and 16.5 per cent, respectively.

Also read p5

QUICKLY.

Bikewo, Yubhas to test solar-assisted e3Ws



Hyderabad: Bikewo Green Tech has partnered with Yubhas Renewables to test solar-assisted electric three-wheelers for rural and semi-urban last-mile mobility ahead of a proposed market rollout. “The partnership allows us to evaluate promising clean mobility technology while exploring rural livelihood opportunities,” said Hiten Pal Saklani, CEO, Bikewo. Yubhas Renewables CEO Sai Satyam Pradhan said feedback will help improve the vehicle’s reliability, affordability and commercial viability. BikeWo will deploy the vehicles across its rider network to evaluate range, battery efficiency, payload capacity, ride quality, thermal performance, braking, operating costs and reliability. Feedback will be used to refine vehicle design and performance. The companies are also exploring rural entrepreneurship programme to train youth in vehicle operation, maintenance and customer service. **OUR BUREAU**

CAFE-III to benefit automakers with a wide range of fuel options

ROAD SHOW. To help JSW MG Motor, VinFast; Nissan may fail to meet emission targets

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Automakers with the maximum number of fleets in alternative fuel options will benefit the most under the CAFE-III norms. While newcomers such as JSW MG Motor India and VinFast will benefit under the regulations, companies such as Renault India and Nissan Motor may suffer a bit on meeting emission targets.

SAFEGUARDS IN PLACE But such companies can still have safeguards because of the super carbon credits that they can purchase from the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) as per the policy, industry sources told *businessline*. “As per the draft policy, automakers that exceed emission reduction targets will be allowed to trade surplus carbon credits with manufacturers that fall short, subject to mutually agreed terms, so it is a win-win policy for all. OEMs who don’t meet the targets can purchase the credits from



WHAT’S IN STORE? The Ministry of Power has sought suggestions from stakeholders on CAFE-III norms

another OEM or BEE,” said an industry executive requesting anonymity. The Ministry of Power (MoP) on Thursday released draft Corporate Average Fuel Economy 2027 Norms (CAFE-III) and sought suggestions from stakeholders in the next 21 days, after which the said draft CAFE 2027 will be taken into consideration, said the MoP. According to another industry executive, companies such as Renault India and Nissan Motor India can partner to get the carbon credits since they don’t have alternative fuel or electric vehicle

(EVs) in their fleet as of now. Companies such as Honda Cars India are safe because they have strong electric hybrid in their portfolio, the executive added. However, Renault India plans to launch strong-hybrid vehicles by end of this year, and the company also plans to launch seven new vehicles by 2030, including electrified powertrains. But Nissan’s current focus remains on internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles, while it continues to evaluate hybrid and other technologies with its teams in Japan and India.

The company also noted that it has to buy the hybrid system at a higher cost and the additional expense would inevitably be reflected in the final price to customers. Thierry Sabbagh, Divisional Vice-President and President - Middle East, KSA and India, Nissan Group AMEO, said recently: “We will introduce the right solutions when market conditions are appropriate... Nissan also has global expertise in flex-fuel technologies. We work closely with policymakers to understand future regulatory requirements, and will bring the appropriate technologies to market when needed.”

GEMA HAILS MOVE According to Grain Ethanol Manufacturers Association (GEMA), as India moves towards higher ethanol blends and the gradual adoption of flex-fuel vehicles, policy measures such as CAFE-III will help create a supportive ecosystem for expanding the use of domestically produced renewable fuels.

RJio Platform Q1 profit rises 9% on subscriber addition, ARPU growth

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Reliance Jio Platform’s net profit increased 9 per cent year-on-year to ₹7,764 crore in the quarter ended June, while revenue grew 12 per cent, driven by continued gains in subscriber market share, organic ARPU growth and scale up of digital services.

EBITDA RISES Its EBITDA rose to ₹20,865 crore, registering a 15 per cent year-on-year increase, supported by strong double-digit revenue growth and a 150 basis points (bps) margin expansion. However, the growth was partially offset by higher finance costs and depreciation charge due to 5G asset capitalisation. **SUBSCRIBER BASE** On a year-on-year basis, the subscriber base grew 7.1 per cent, while ARPU rose 3.3 per cent to over ₹215.6 per subscriber per month. The total subscriber base stood at around 533.3 million, reflecting a sequential growth of 1.6 per cent. Monthly churn remained at 1.6 per cent, while net sub-

Scorecard				(₹cr)
Jio Platforms	Q1FY26	Q4FY26	Q1FY27	
Gross revenue	41,054	44,928	45,961	
Profit	7,110	7,935	7,764	
EBITDA	18,135	20,060	20,865	

scriber additions reached 8.9 million. On a sequential basis, net profit declined 2 per cent, with EBITDA growth partially offset by higher finance costs and depreciation charge due to 5G asset capitalisation. Meanwhile, gross revenue increased 2.2 per cent. “Jio has established itself as a deep tech company and demonstrated the velocity of innovation across multiple advanced technologies. This is underlined by our strong patent portfolio, which has been recognised globally. We intend to use these technologies to offer an ever-expanding bouquet of services to every citizen of India and drive industry-leading growth for many years to come,” said Akash M Ambani, Chairman of Reliance Jio Infocomm. “As we embark on our next phase of journey to be a publicly listed company in India, we will continue to maintain our deep tech focus and democratise access to digital connectivity and digital services in India and globally,” added Akash. Data traffic reached 66 billion GB, marking a 5.9 per cent sequential increase and a 35 per cent year-on-year rise. Per capita data consumption stood at 42.7 GB per month. Voice traffic remained flat, while Jio’s True5G subscribers base expanded to 285 million. JioAirFiber reported 14 million subscribers. **‘KEY MILESTONE’** “During the quarter, Jio Platforms filed its DRHP with SEBI, a significant step towards its public listing,” said Mukesh D Ambani, Reliance Industries Ltd Chairman and Managing Director. “The upcoming IPO will be an important milestone in Jio’s journey, and will give investors an opportunity to participate in India’s digital growth story,” he said, voicing optimism for FY27 as the company unlocks value through the Jio IPO.

JioStar maintains TV leadership, reports 15% jump in Q1 profit

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Reliance Industries’ media arm JioStar reported a 14.5 per cent increase in net profit at ₹665 crore, while revenue grew 14 per cent to ₹12,799 crore, led by strong growth in subscription revenue and digital entertainment advertising revenue. The company reported EBITDA of ₹1,049 crore, driven by operating leverage amid robust revenue growth during the quarter ended June. Sequentially, profit grew by 59 per cent and gross revenue increased by 31 per cent. The management highlighted JioStar’s strong performance despite macroeconomic pressures and

The management highlighted JioStar’s strong performance despite macroeconomic pressures and weakness in the advertising market

weakness in the advertising market. The network retained its leadership position in key markets with TV entertainment viewership share at 34.2 per cent share, reaching over 810 million viewers nationally. The viewership share was nearly equal to the combined share of the next

three largest networks. JioHotstar averaged 530 million monthly active users, its highest average to date, led by a strong uptick in viewership across sports and entertainment. IPL’s digital reach touched 700 million viewers, while entertainment watch time on JioHotstar reached a new high, growing 16 per cent year-on-year. JioStar maintained its number one position in TV entertainment, with viewership share at 34 per cent. “The watch-time share of regional languages during IPL rose by 33 per cent on digital, reinforcing JioStar’s reach across premium and regional audiences. Despite macro challenges, IPL 2026 drove strong monetisation,” said the company.

Reliance Retail revenue rises 7% at ₹90,408 crore in Q1

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



GOOD SHOW. Transactions across Reliance Retail rose to 568 million from 389 million

Reliance Retail on Friday reported a 7.4 per cent rise in Q1FY27 revenue at ₹90,408 crore from ₹84,171 crore in Q1 FY26, supported by double-digit underlying growth across grocery, consumer electronics and fashion and lifestyle. Adjusted for the Reliance Consumer Products demerger, gross revenue grew 11.6 per cent as JioMart’s average daily orders jumped 116 per cent and transactions increased 46 per cent. Profit after tax, however, fell 14.2 per cent to ₹2,806 crore from ₹3,271 crore, while EBITDA declined 1.1 per cent to ₹6,309 crore from ₹6,381 crore and margin contracted 80 basis points to 7.9 per cent due to the scale-

up of digital commerce. EBITDA also missed the Street’s ₹6,600-6,990 crore estimate range. The company attributed the 80 basis point contraction in EBITDA margin to 7.9 per cent from 8.7 per cent to the scale-up of digital commerce. Nomura had estimated Retail EBITDA at ₹6,600 crore, ICICI Securities at ₹6,830 crore and Emkay

Global at ₹6,990 crore. The reported figure missed the lowest estimate by 4.4 per cent. Reliance Industries’ regulatory filing also showed Retail EBIT declined 6.9 per cent to ₹4,529 crore from ₹4,866 crore in Q1 FY26, a sharper fall than EBITDA after depreciation and amortisation. **DIGITAL COMMERCE** Transactions across Reliance

Retail rose to 568 million from 389 million. JioMart serviced about 5,500 pin codes, with more than 2,500 digital and fashion and lifestyle stores connected to two-hour delivery, while customers using both digital and physical channels spent 2.7 times as much as pure offline customers. The registered customer base increased 10.6 per cent to 396 million from 358 million, while unique customers served across Retail formats grew 8.5 per cent year-on-year. The faster increase in orders and transactions than in revenue points to the growing contribution of high-frequency, smaller-basket digital purchases. Reliance opened 252 stores during the quarter, taking the network to 20,169 stores from 19,592 stores in Q1FY26, an increase of 2.9 per cent. Its operating area rose 1 per cent to 78.4 million square feet from 77.6 million square feet. Grocery recorded like-for-like growth of 7 per cent, supported by regional festivals and category-focused events. Fashion and lifestyle posted 4 per cent like-for-like growth, aided by merchandise freshness and store refreshes. Consumer electronics registered 16 per cent like-for-like growth, supported by higher average bill values and demand for air conditioners, laptops, mobile phones and small appliances. Ajio Rush recorded a 136 per cent sequential increase in orders. Shein app installations crossed 30 million, while the resQ services business increased revenue 27 per cent year-on-year.

JSW Steel net doubles to ₹4,696 cr on better realisation

Our Bureau
Mumbai

JSW Steel has reported that its net profit in the June quarter of FY27 more than doubled to ₹4,696 crore against ₹2,209 crore logged in the same period last year, largely due to better realisation and fall in finance costs. Revenue increased 10 per cent to ₹47,364 crore (₹43,147 crore). The company plans to raise ₹811 crore by offloading stake in the proposed JSW One Platforms initial public offering. Promoted by the JSW Group, the B2B (business to business) platform is backed by SBI, Principal Asset Management and OneUp.

Founded in 2020, the tech-driven marketplace was valued at \$1 billion during a ₹340 crore fundraising round in May last year. JSW Steel’s sales volume was up 4 per cent in the June quarter at 6.25 million tonnes (6.03 mt). EBITDA per tonne was up 27 per cent at ₹14,990 (₹11,783). **RISE IN EBITDA** EBITDA increased 32 per cent to ₹9,373 crore (₹7,106 crore). Net debt on a sequential basis was down ₹7,713 crore at ₹46,157 crore as of June-end. Of the planned capex of about ₹24,000 crore this fiscal, the company

Q1 scorecard (in ₹ cr)			
	Q1 FY26	Q1 FY27	
Net profit	2,209	4,696	
Revenue	43,147	47,364	
EPS (₹) (Diluted)	8.93	19.02	



spent ₹4,869 crore in the June quarter. Its Indian operations registered revenues of ₹42,894 crore and EBITDA of ₹9,096 crore. The company has completed the joint venture with JFE for Bhushan Power and Steel asset, with JFE investing the second tranche of ₹7,875 crore as of June-end. JSW Vijayanagar Metals recorded a net profit of ₹1,223 crore. It registered an

EBITDA of ₹1,821 crore, mainly driven by higher sales volume as the operations ramped up and higher sales realisations. The net profit of JSW Steel Coated Products was ₹354 crore on a revenue of ₹9,991 crore. EBITDA increased 25 per cent to ₹698 crore, primarily due to higher sales realisations. The company has completed capacity expansion of

blast furnace-3 to 4.5 mtpa from 3 mtpa at Vijayanagar and it was lit up in June. It has since ramped up to over 80 per cent in a few weeks, and will add incremental volumes from September quarter. **CAPACITY EXPANSION** JSW Steel plans to enhance capacity at planned downstream expansion by 0.44 million tonnes at Vijayanagar, Khopoli and Rajpura. At Khopoli, it has enhanced the product capability to include a wide range of high-strength, value-added coated steel products, and added rail capability to the 1 mtpa structural mill in Raigarh.

Ultraviolette Automotive targets monthly sales of 1,000 units by year-end, says CEO

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Premium electric two-wheeler maker Ultraviolette Automotive is accelerating its scale-up plans, targeting monthly sales of 1,000 units by the end of 2026 as it gears up for its next phase of growth ahead of a planned initial public offering (IPO) and the commercial rollout of its electric scooter Tesseract. **PRODUCTION FACILITY** Speaking to *businessline*, Narayan Subramaniam, CEO and Co-founder of Ultravio-

lette, said the company is preparing the second phase of its manufacturing facility, which will increase annual production capacity to 1.5 lakh vehicles from the current 50,000-60,000 units. **FIRST E-SCOOTER** The expansion comes as the Bengaluru-based company prepares to begin deliveries of its electric scooter Tesseract in the first quarter of 2027. The company said the scooter had already received over 80,000 bookings, providing visibility on demand ahead of commercial production. Ultraviolette is simultaneously expanding

its retail footprint to support the next growth phase. The company currently operates 45 experience centres across India, and plans to nearly double that number to around 100 by the end of the year through its dealer-partner network. It is also aiming to increase monthly vehicle sales from the current run rate of over 600 motorcycles to 1,000 units by the year-end. Subramaniam said the upcoming capacity expansion had been planned not only to meet domestic demand for Tesseract but also to support Ultraviolette’s broader product pipeline.

Biggest challenge is recovering raw material inflation costs, says Ceat CFO

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Ceat is grappling with a growth-versus-margin dilemma as sharp raw material inflation erodes profitability despite strong demand and double-digit revenue growth. The company has raised replacement tyre prices by a cumulative 10.5-11 per cent through July 1 and announced another 3 per cent hike for the second half of July, with a further increase planned in August. While Q1FY27 consolidated revenues rose 22.4 per cent to ₹4,318 crore, net profit plunged 96.4 per cent to ₹4 crore as raw material costs surged

nearly 20 per cent quarter-on-quarter, far outpacing the 4.5 per cent average pricing benefit. With input costs expected to rise another 7-8 per cent in Q2, Ceat faces the challenge of restoring margins without hurting demand or market share. Ceat CFO Kumar Subbiah discusses the company’s response to commodity inflation, rupee depreciation and supply-chain disruptions, and shares his outlook on pricing, demand, Camso, capex, debt and margin recovery. **Edited excerpts:** **How much did raw material costs increase during Q1? How much pricing has Ceat taken and what is the remaining gap?**

Raw material costs rose nearly 20 per cent q-o-q in Q1, driven mainly by natural rubber, which increased from about ₹180/kg to ₹280/kg. Ceat expects a further 7-8 per cent increase in Q2. The company raised replacement market prices by 6-7 per cent in Q1, translating into about 4.5 per cent average realisation benefit. Additional hikes of 3-3.5 per cent from July 1, 3 per cent in late July and another increase planned for August are expected to narrow the gap. Ceat aims to recover most of the cost increase by the end of Q2, though some lag may remain. **Could repeated price increases weaken demand, and what is Ceat’s growth outlook?**

While a weaker rupee has modestly improved export realisations, it has also increased input costs, limiting net benefits. **KUMAR SUBBIAH** CFO, Ceat Demand remains strong despite industry-wide price hikes. Q1 standalone revenue grew 18.7 per cent y-o-y, with roughly one-third from pricing and two-thirds from volume growth. Replacement, OEM and international businesses posted double-digit growth. Ceat expects strong



double-digit growth in FY27, supported by both volumes and pricing. **Has the weaker rupee helped exports, and how is Ceat managing the wider West Asia disruption?** While a weaker rupee has modestly improved export realisations, it has also in-

creased input costs, limiting net benefits. Exports account for about 20 per cent of standalone revenues. Ceat increased international prices by 5-7 per cent on fresh orders, and is focusing on higher-margin geographies and products. To manage West Asia disruption, it secured raw-material supplies early, reduced discretionary spending, restricted travel, slowed hiring and strengthened currency hedging. **Where does the Camso business stand, and when will Ceat provide growth and margin guidance?** Camso was flat to slightly down in Q1. Ceat expects to complete most customer-facing and sales integration by the end of Q2, and plans to

provide clearer growth and profitability guidance from Q3. **Will margin pressure affect Ceat’s capex, and should investors expect debt to rise?** Ceat spent about ₹300 crore on capex in Q1 and continues to prioritise capacity-expansion projects. FY27 capex guidance of ₹1,300-1,400 crore remains unchanged for now. Debt rose about ₹90 crore in Q1, mainly due to higher raw material inventory. The company expects most capex to be funded through internal accruals, with only limited additional borrowing if required. **When should investors expect margins to recover, and what is**

Ceat’s broader FY27 guidance? Margin pressure is likely to persist in Q2 as input costs rise faster than pricing gains. Ceat expects to recover most of the raw material inflation by the end of Q2, with Q3 likely to see improvement if commodity prices stabilise. It remains focused on strong double-digit growth, gradual margin recovery and stronger profitability in H2FY27. **businessline.** **Disclaimer:** Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THE PUBLISHING PRT LTD, the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/in liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

RBI takes a step towards polymer banknotes

INVITES BIDS. Subsidiary floats EoI for manufacture, supply of sheets for plastic currency

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

India appears to have taken a major step towards introducing polymer banknotes, with the RBI-owned Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran (P) Ltd (BRBN-MPL) floating a global expression of interest (EoI) for manufacturing and supply of polymer substrate used to print plastic currency notes.

The development follows last month's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) post-policy press conference, where RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra acknowledged that the proposal was under consideration.

"We will let you know as soon as a decision is made," he said while adding that the central bank is examining the pros and cons and "whether it will be worthwhile to do it. It is still at a preliminary stage."

The indicated requirement, according to the EoI document dated July 17, for 'Biaxially oriented polypropylene (BOPP)-based opacified polymer substrate with security features for printing of Indian banknotes' has been set at 68,000 reams,



UNDER STUDY. The central bank is also examining the pros and cons of plastic currency notes

with 34,000 reams for each denomination. Each ream will consist of 500 sheets.

The bidder should offer minimum 30 per cent of the above quantity, ie, at least 20,400 reams of polymer substrate for banknotes to qualify in this EoI, the document said.

COMPETITIVE BIDS

"We seek competitive offers from manufacturers and suppliers of opacified polymer substrate with security features suitable for printing banknotes. The indicative requirement in this EoI is meant for immediate requirement. Once our field trials are successful, we intend to go for procurement of larger quantity of substrate across different de-

nominations and the same is likely to be shared in the upcoming RFP/final tender or in future tenders which shall follow this EoI," the document said.

The document mentioned that the bidder should have essentially manufactured and supplied polymer substrate with security features to any central bank or bank-note printing organisation or security product printing organisation for at least last three years ending March 31, 2026.

It should have manufactured and supplied at least 30 per cent of the offered quantity of the polymer substrate for banknotes to any central bank or banknote printing organisation or security product printing organisa-

tion in any one year during the last five years ending March 31, 2026.

Further, the bidder must have an annual capacity to manufacture and supply at least 30 per cent of the quantity of polymer substrate offered by them.

The evidence for annual capacity must be provided with a list of equipment and capacity, the document said, adding that the net worth of the firm should not be negative as on March 31, 2025, and also should not have eroded by more than 30 per cent year-on-year in the last three financial years ending March 31, 2025.

PRINTING NOTES

According to the RBI annual report, a total of 2,810 crore pieces of currency notes were supplied by BRBNMPL and the Security Printing and Minting Corporation of India Ltd (SPMCIL). The central bank spent over ₹4,800 crore during the fiscal on printing notes. During the same year, it destroyed 1,700 crore pieces of soiled notes. In the same year, the value and volume of banknotes in circulation increased by 11.9 per cent and 10.5 per cent, respectively.

West Asia crisis, uncertain monsoon major risks for growth: RBI Governor

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Reserve Bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra has said that the West Asia crisis and the expectation of a weak monsoon present significant risks to economic growth.

"Despite global uncertainties, India has witnessed an over 7 per cent growth rate in the past few years. Last financial year, India clocked a growth rate of 7.7 per cent supported by strong and robust macroeconomic fundamentals," he said in an interview to *DD News*.

GDP OUTLOOK

The Reserve Bank of India has projected a GDP growth of 6.6 per cent for the current financial year despite various challenges, he said.

"Monetary and fiscal policies are robust, and because of that, we are witnessing high GDP growth," the Governor added.

On inflation, he said the central bank had raised its inflation forecast to 5.1 per cent for FY27, higher from its earlier estimate of 4.6 per cent.

Inflation going past the Reserve Bank's median target of 4 per cent in June was



Monetary and fiscal policies are robust and because of that, we are witnessing high GDP growth

SANJAY MALHOTRA
RBI Governor



largely driven by supply-side factors, Malhotra noted.

Retail inflation climbed to 4.38 per cent in June from 3.93 per cent in May, mainly due to costlier food items.

Food inflation increased to 5.32 per cent in June from 4.78 per cent in the preceding month.

Talking about another risk factor, Malhotra said that how the monsoon behaves is crucial, as a large population depends on the agriculture sector.

Agriculture contributes about 17 per cent to the GDP, he said, adding that "we have to be vigilant about that (monsoon)."

RUPEE DEPRECIATION

On the rupee depreciation, he said the domestic currency's performance against peers remains stable despite a stronger dollar and

heightened global uncertainty. "After the war in West Asia, the dollar has become strong. The currencies of many countries have weakened. If we look at it from a global perspective, India's rupee situation can be considered normal," he said.

Last year, the gross FDI was around \$95 billion, which was a record, Malhotra said, adding that net foreign direct investment in the first two months of the current financial year was around \$7 billion. "In the medium and long term, our balance of payments and our external sector will remain strong. There is no need to worry," he said.

Malhotra further said the RBI will continue to prioritise inflation while supporting economic growth, and low and stable inflation provides the foundation for

sustainable growth. Inflation control remains the RBI's primary objective under the flexible inflation-targeting framework, while growth was its secondary objective.

"They are not in opposition. They support each other," he added.

Asked about the loan growth, the Governor said credit growth remained broad-based across sectors. Overall bank credit grew around 18 per cent year-on-year in June against 17.5 per cent in May, he said.

AI ADOPTION

On artificial intelligence adoption, Malhotra said the RBI had encouraged banks to adopt AI to improve customer service, lower operating costs, and enhance decision-making while ensuring safeguards against cybersecurity and data privacy risks.

Earlier this week, the Governor, while addressing managing directors and chief executive officers of public and select private sector banks, asked them to leverage advanced technologies, including AI, to expand their reach while ensuring robust cybersecurity and safeguards against fraud and data misuse.

India, Japan agree to launch bullet train operations with indigenous trainsets until E10 arrives: MEA

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India and Japan have agreed to commence operations on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed rail corridor using indigenously developed high-speed trainsets until Japan's next-generation E10 Shinkansen becomes available in the early 2030s, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Friday.

The clarification comes amid speculation over the rolling stock planned for India's first bullet train project. At a media briefing, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said discussions between India and Japan on the high-speed rail project were progressing well. According to the MEA, Japan will provide the E10 train series, currently under development, only in the early 2030s. Since the first section of the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed rail corridor is scheduled to become opera-



WORK IN PROGRESS. A view of a station under construction as part of the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed train corridor *ANI*

tional in 2027, both countries have agreed to begin commercial operations with an Indian high-speed train.

E10 TRAIN SERIES

"Japan will provide E10 train series but only in early 2030s. The train in question is still under development. Meanwhile, construction work has rapidly progressed. First section will be opened in 2027 itself. Therefore, both sides agreed to start the opera-

tions with Indian high-speed train," Jaiswal said.

Besides, he added that signalling equipment for the project had already been ordered in line with this operational plan, and the same conforms to international specifications.

The spokesperson rejected suggestions that Japan had made any alternative proposal regarding the trainsets. "No Japanese offer was received in this context," he

said. As per the MEA, implementation of the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed rail project continues in line with the shared objective of commencing operations at the earliest.

The rail corridor is being implemented with Japanese financial and technological assistance. It will be India's first bullet train project and is expected to serve as the template for future high-speed rail corridors in the country.

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Banking services must reach every village: FM

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday said the Centre's objective is to ensure the reach of banking services across every village and facilitate easier access for small entrepreneurs to institutional credit.

Speaking at a mega credit outreach programme in Narasaraopet, Andhra Pradesh, Sitharaman said public sector banks were increasingly reaching out to entrepreneurs and extending loans at their doorstep.

Recalling the challenges in the banking system when she assumed office, the Finance Minister said banks were burdened with high levels of non-performing assets, while small entrepreneurs struggled to secure loans.

Recognising these constraints, Prime Minister Nar-



CREDIT PUSH. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at a loan distribution programme at Palnadu in Andhra Pradesh *PTI*

endra Modi introduced credit schemes backed by government guarantees, enabling banks to lend more readily to small businesses, she said.

LOAN DISBURSAL

Sitharaman and Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu distributed loan sanction letters and cheques worth ₹3,216 crore to 1,03,246 beneficiar-

ies in Palnadu district. The beneficiaries included 15,000 women belonging to the Development of Women and Children in Rural Areas (DWCRA) groups and 13,355 entrepreneurs.

Addressing the gathering, Naidu said Palnadu should emerge as a hub for entrepreneurs. The State government's objective was to ensure access to credit for every eligible farmer, stu-

dent, self-help group member and entrepreneur, he said. "Banks are not merely lending institutions but key partners in the State's development," Naidu said.

Highlighting the performance of women's self-help groups, Naidu said Andhra Pradesh's 10 lakh DWCRA groups had accumulated savings of ₹29,000 crore and achieved a loan repayment rate of 99.5 per cent.

The Chief Minister said the Centre's support was helping Andhra Pradesh take forward projects and initiatives related to Amaravati, Polavaram and the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant.

The State would receive ₹7,707 crore from the Centre under the VB-G RAM G programme, while financial support of ₹40,000 crore was being extended to develop Rayalaseema as a horticulture hub, he said, according to a release.

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NOTICE OF 41st ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, INFORMATION ON REMOTE E-VOTING AND OTHER INFORMATION

NOTICE is hereby given that the 41st Annual General Meeting ('AGM') of the members of Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited (hereinafter referred as 'the Company') will be held through Video Conference ('VC') or Other Audio Visual Means ('OAVM') on **Monday, August 10, 2026 at 03:00 PM (IST)**, pursuant to and in compliance with the circulars issued by MCA and SEBI in this regard (hereinafter referred to as 'the Circulars') and all other applicable laws to transact the business as set out in the notice of the 41st AGM.

In compliance with the aforesaid circulars, the Integrated Annual Report of the Company for the FY26 along with the notice of AGM and other reports/documents ('AGM documents') were sent to the shareholders on **Friday, July 17, 2026**, in electronic mode only, whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ('RTA') or Company or the Depositories. Further, in accordance with Regulation 36 (I) (b) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ('Listing Regulations'), a letter providing a web-link and QR code for accessing the Integrated Annual Report, including the exact path, is being sent to those shareholders who have not registered their email addresses with the Company.

The AGM documents are available on Company's website <https://www.amararajeandm.com> and also on the websites of the stock exchanges i.e., BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and also on the website of National Securities Depository Limited <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com>

Pursuant to Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 ('the Act') read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2015 and Regulations 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company is pleased to provide e-voting facility to members to cast their vote on all the resolutions set forth in the notice convening the 41st AGM. The members may cast their vote electronically through electronic voting system of National Securities Depository Limited ('NSDL') before the AGM as well as during the AGM.

Particulars	Event Dates/Particulars
Date of AGM (VC/OAVM)	Monday, August 10, 2026 at 3:00 P.M. (IST)
Record Date for Dividend	Monday, July 27, 2026 To those members whose names appear in the register of members or in case of shares held in dematerialized form to the beneficiaries as of the close of business hours of the Record Date.
Book Closure Dates	Tuesday, July 28, 2026, to Saturday, August 01, 2026 (both days inclusive)
Cut Off Date for e-voting	Monday, August 03, 2026 Only members whose names appear in the register of members or beneficial owners as of the cut-off date can vote through e-voting before or during the AGM. Any person who acquires shares and becomes a member after the despatch of the 41 st AGM but holds shares as of the cut-off date, can get their login ID and password by emailing to evoting@nsdl.co.in or contacting the Company/RTA. If already registered with NSDL, members can use existing user ID and password to vote.
Remote e-voting will commence on	Thursday, August 06, 2026 (9:00 A.M. IST)
Remote e-voting will end on	Sunday, August 09, 2026 (5:00 P.M. IST) The remote e-voting shall be disabled by NSDL thereafter. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by member, he / she / it shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.

ALL MEMBERS ARE FURTHER INFORMED THAT,

A.The ordinary and special businesses as set out in the Notice of AGM may be transacted through voting by remote e-voting before or during the AGM.

B. The facility of e-voting shall also be made available during the AGM on **Monday, August 10, 2026**. Those members present at the AGM through VC/OAVM, who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting and are otherwise not debarred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through the e-voting system during the AGM on **Monday, August 10, 2026** and the members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM, may attend the AGM but will not be entitled to cast their vote again.

C. The instructions for remote e-voting, e-voting during the AGM, participation in the AGM through VC/OAVM and manner in which the user ID and passwords can be obtained by members whose email address are not registered with Company/Depository to enable them to cast their vote and register their email address, are provided in the notes to the Notice of the 41st AGM.

D. Members who have not registered their email address are requested to send a request to the Registrar and Transfer Agent of the Company i.e. Cameo Corporate Services Limited at investor@cameoindia.com or to the Company at investorservices@amararaja.com respectively to obtain the AGM documents or user ID and password for remote e-voting or for attending the AGM through VC/OAVM by providing the following details:

Mode of Holding:	Details to be provided:
Physical	Folio No., Name of shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card)
Demat	DP ID and Client ID (16-digit DPID + CLID or 16-digit beneficiary ID), Name of shareholder, client master or copy of Consolidated Account statement, PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card)

E. Subject to the approval of shareholders at the 41st AGM, the Board of Directors at their meeting held on Monday, May 25, 2026, recommended a final dividend of ₹ 5.20/- (520%) per equity share for the FY26. The final dividend, if approved, at the 41st AGM, will be paid on or before Wednesday, September 09, 2026, through various modes. To avoid delay in receiving the dividend, shareholders are requested to update their KYC with their depositories and with RTA.

F. The Board of Directors have appointed Mr. R Sridharan, Practising Company Secretary (Membership No. FCS 4775 and CP No. 3239) Managing Partner, M/s. R. Sridharan & Associates, Company Secretaries as a Scrutinizer and failing him Ms. Srinidhi Sridharan, (Membership No. FCS 12510 and CP No. 17990) from M/s Srinidhi Sridharan & Associates, Company Secretaries, as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting prior to the AGM and e-voting process during the AGM in a fair and transparent manner.

For Any Queries/Grievances regarding e-voting facility, please contact:

Company	NSDL	Registrar and Share Transfer Agent
Write a mail at investorservices@amararaja.com	Refer to the FAQs for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of https://www.evoting.nsdl.com Contact: NSDL, 4th Floor, 'A' Wing, Trade World, Kamala Mills Compound, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400 013. Email: evoting@nsdl.co.in or at Toll free no: 1800 1020 990 and 1800 22 44 30	Cameo Corporate Services Limited, Unit: Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited Subramanian Building, No.1, Club House Road, Chennai - 600002, Tel: 91 44 28460390, Portal: https://wisdom.cameoindia.com/ Email ID: investor@cameoindia.com Website: www.cameoindia.com

For Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited

Place: Hyderabad
Date: July 17, 2026

Sd/-
Vikas Sabharwal
Company Secretary & General Counsel

QUICKLY.

Kia Syros EV announced; bookings open



The Syros now has an EV counterpart — the Syros EV. Offered with two battery pack options, 42 kWh and 51.4 kWh, borrowed from the Carens Clavis EV and Creta Electric, the Syros EV comes with a claimed (ARAI) range of 443 km and 526 km respectively. Visually, the Syros EV and ICE versions feature minor distinctions while equipment levels are yet to be revealed. With a choice of either a 133 bhp or a 168 bhp motor, you can expect a more spirited performance from the EV.

Yamaha FZ flex-fuel variant launched at ₹1.24 lakh



Sceptical about ethanol-related issues? Yamaha has some relief to offer in the form of the FZ Blue Flex. Featuring a 149cc, single-cylinder, air-cooled engine, the FZ Blue Flex offers compatibility with ethanol-blended petrol ranging from E20 to E85. You can get your hands on it in one colour only (metallic black) at select Blue Square dealerships in Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana and Tamil Nadu. Yamaha claims no revisions to its output figures and it is priced at ₹1.24 lakh, ex-showroom, Delhi.

JSW-MG unveils new ADAPT platform



Short for Advance drive architecture platform technology (ADAPT), it is JSW-MG's modular new energy vehicle (NEV) platform, meant to support EVs across formats — conventional, plug-in hybrids and range-extenders. This platform, JSW-MG states, integrates a hybrid powerplant, a battery system and a hybrid transmission, all co-ordinated by an energy management system. The first of its EV and PHEV models based on this platform is expected to make a debut before the end of FY26-27.

@TheMotorGram



ROMAN DEVMANE

At Ease

PLUG AND PLAY. The Sierra.ev is more than just an obvious extension of its ICE counterpart. Has Tata executed it to perfection, though?

Ruman Devmane

I strongly believe Tata was on the cusp of its ‘Thar’ moment with the Sierra. You know, nostalgia mixed with youthful appeal packed into a liberally configured car that didn’t have to play by the rules. Sure, in doing so, Tata might have threatened to cannibalise some of its other SUVs (so did the Thar, to other Mahindras) — and it does anyway — but the Sierra and its EV counterpart would have emerged with a stronger sense of individuality as a result. For now, the Sierra is a bit conformist; great at lots of things and yet somewhat emotionally distant.

If you can look past that, the Sierra.ev is perhaps the most compelling SUV of its kind, certainly Tata’s finest yet. What is it, exactly? Positioned to slot in neatly between the Curvv.ev and the Harrier.ev, the Sierra.ev is meant to be a family-friendly SUV. To that effect, it features a robust spec sheet, a spacious cabin, and tough underpinnings. In EV form, it’s subtly different (if not necessarily better or worse) to the ICE Sierra, with changes being made to bits of trim and, of course, a cleaner front-end that makes do without a grille as such, among other finer details.

POWER OF THREE

Tata has equipped the Sierra.ev with three powertrains, consisting of 63 kWh and 75 kWh single-motor variants and the flagship, (also 75 kWh) which features a dual-motor setup and a segment-first all-wheel drive unit. The 63 kWh version is the most powerful of the single-motor range, producing 234.7 bhp (the 75 kWh version produces 206.1 bhp), while the dual-motor version (our test unit) produces a combined power output of 344.2 bhp, with 138 bhp being supplied by the front-mounted induction motor.

There’s a lot Tata offers on the tech front, too. A comprehensive ADAS suite (which remains turned off through reboots once you’ve deactivated it), a 12-speaker JBL audio package with Dolby Atmos, an air-purifier and also a clever Google



SPACE AGE. An airy, comfortable and spacious cabin is among the Sierra.ev’s biggest strengths. The boot space is ample but it offers neither a spare nor a space-saver! RUMAN DEVMANE

Maps integration (it plans routes based on SOC and even takes into consideration charging time to indicate an ETA) are some of its genuinely insightful features.

SPACE IMPACT

Before we get to the drive experience, it’s important that you spare the cabin a moment, because it’s terrific on many fronts. The use of light materials, modern surfaces, huge glass areas and a panoramic sunroof delivers a heightened sense of space — and it is inherently spacious anyway. The front seats are very comfortable and offer six-way adjustment, a manual underthigh extension and ventilation, the flat-bottom steering wheel feels premium to hold, and most of the surfaces feel perfectly contemporary. Oh, and I love the dash-mounted panel (to the right of the steering wheel) which features buttons for the drive modes and a chunky knob for the 6 terrain modes it offers. The rear seat is especially nice, too, replete with an ergonomic

armrest, manual sun shades and, most importantly, a flat, low-set floor that ensures you don’t end up sitting knees-up.

For some reason, Tata has reverted to piano black in places, and it instantly takes away from the Sierra.ev’s elevated sense of sophistication. Space management is a bit odd, too. For a car with this kind of in-cabin real estate, the Sierra.ev could have offered a lot more stowage and also a generally smarter layout and interface. At present, it’s quite prominently wasteful, especially around the centre console area. Of course, Tata would rather you transfixed your gaze on its elaborate, three-screen setup. It’s neatly finished and the user interface is quite good although I found it a bit excessive, to put it politely.

The boot is generous but comes only with a puncture-repair kit and, worse still, opens to a low aperture which means anyone over 5’8” is certain to inherit at least one hard knock on their head. I know because I did, and it really hurt. I wish

Tata had offered a split tailgate instead, something that would only have benefited the Sierra’s ‘lifestyle’ appeal and functionality.

GENTLE GIANT

To drive, the Sierra.ev feels sublime. It’s a powerful car, sure, but I think gentle, surefooted momentum is more its forte than outwardly aggressive driving. Given the frame of mind its plush cabin put me in, I rarely felt the urge to drive it menacingly. For the first 40 km, I stayed in Eco mode and found it to be perfectly suited to the urban crawl, and with regenerative braking set to L3 (strongest), it offered a relaxing single-pedal drive. City mode emerged as my favourite as we transitioned from the city onto the highway, for its balanced power delivery paired with intuitive throttle calibration without eating much into efficiency.

I ventured into Sport sparingly — Boost even less — as I found it to be too responsive in a way that didn’t suit the otherwise calming

experience the Sierra.ev relays. I don’t, for a moment, doubt it can match Tata’s 0-100 kph claim of 5.8 seconds, though. On the other hand, Tata’s other claim of an MIDC range of 535-665 km (63 kWh and 75 kWh variants, respectively) isn’t entirely off the mark either. I’d say it’ll do 500 km on a full charge and under a mixed driving style confidently.

What’s equally noteworthy is the ride quality, stability and overall dynamics package of the Sierra.ev. Aiming for the crudest of potholes, the SUV not only absorbed it all but also insulated the cabin from creaks and thuds and creaks in a respectable manner. Around bends, it sure makes you aware of its heft with a noticeable degree of body roll which, frankly, doesn’t feel out of place for a car of its proportions. Braking felt spot-on, too, and along with great bite and progression, the Sierra.ev also inspires confidence through its composure.

I did, in fact, experience the Sierra.ev on a curated off-road course — those are famously favourable, being bespoke layouts — but even through the most ambitious of sections, the Sierra.ev really did surprise with its capabilities. That it benefits from a good approach/departure angle (courtesy the short overhangs) was easy to see but some of its tech bits (the terrain modes, for instance) ensure it can pretty much drive itself out of trouble through pretty heady situations. Sure, it doesn’t apply to the Sierra.ev’s use-case but that it didn’t stop Tata from making an effort is commendable.

Where Tata didn’t make as much of an effort — and that’s no bad thing — is in pricing the Sierra.ev aggressively. Its price range of ₹18.79 lakh to ₹25.99 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi) feels fair for everything it offers, from comfort to visual appeal and, of course, its elaborate feature set and strong EV takeaways. What’s missing, however, is a Sierra (EV or otherwise) that should have been configured with less restraint. On balance, maybe this is only the beginning of the Sierra story. I, for one, can’t wait to see what shape it takes next.

@TheMotorGram

Ruman Devmane

In case you hadn’t noticed, the Bajaj Dominar is now a decade old. First launched in December 2016, the Dominar was meant to demolish the dominance of Royal Enfield’s 350s, a purpose it wore with pride. An infamous ad campaign cemented this objective into the minds of the Indian audience who, however, didn’t seem particularly enthused. Except, perhaps, on social media. In the real world, 10 years later, the Dominar’s ambition remains a pipe dream.

In its bid to remain relevant (to be fair, it does sell in modest numbers), the Dominar now features a 349 cc engine, in line with Bajaj’s rather clever strategy to slot its sub-400 cc range into a lower GST bracket. The slightly reduced displacement along with a few factory-fitted accessories, such as the visor, hand guards and luggage rack, are what’s new about the Dominar 400 (yes, it continues to be called that) and that felt like enough of an excuse for me to revisit Bajaj’s erstwhile blue-eyed boy.

CRUISE AND CONTROL

As a concept, the Dominar has always been about effortless cruising, engaging dynamics and long-haul comfort, all of which it delivers even today.

I was pleasantly surprised to rediscover how roomy it is and especially how nice the seat is. The riding position is somewhat aggressive but configured for com-



HITS AND MISSES. The Dominar wears its bulk sportingly. ‘New’ motor is marginally more powerful. Seat comfort for the rider and pillion is good. Instrumentation feels dated YASH GAWDE

fortable long-distance rides, and it sure feels like a substantial motorcycle to grip with your knees. The bassy soundtrack that emerged once I’d fired it up promised even more substance. Good, because I was expecting its ‘new’ 349 cc, liquid-cooled, single-cylinder engine to deliver strongly, especially considering it produces a respectable 40 bhp — in fact, 0.6 bhp more than on the now-defunct 373 cc version —

and 3.38 kg-m of torque. That, along with its 6-speed gearbox, four ride modes (Road, Rain, Sport and Off-Road) and additional assistance from traction control and a dual-channel ABS means, on paper, that the Dominar is as well-equipped as ever to make highway rides a breeze. Objectively speaking, it is.

I first rode it in the city, toggling between Road and Sport modes, and it certainly didn’t feel

short on speed. At low speeds, it’s vibe-free and its progressive responses to all inputs certainly lend it a strong degree of intuitivity. What doesn’t work is its combination of an 800 mm seat height, a wide-ish tank aperture and its 190-kg kerb weight.

If you can get past that, you’ll find the Dominar to be an easy, accessible fast-bike you can ride as briskly in the city as along the highway. While Bajaj claims a 146

kph top-speed for the Dominar (unchanged from earlier), the more realistic takeaways of its performance suite are the decent mid-range and its ability to cruise, unstressed, at 100 kph or slightly higher. At those speeds, you’ll find the Dominar to be admirably stable, too. Ride quality is pliant if not premium and braking is strong enough. The tyres, a 110/70-R17 (front) and a 150/60-R17 (rear), seemed to work fuss-free in dry

conditions, at least. What I didn’t get to revisit was the LED headlight; if my memory serves me well, it is among the strongest in the business.

While the Dominar does everything its brief suggests it must, where it lacks is in how it feels while it goes about its duties. Sure, at ₹2.04 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi), it spells tremendous value for everything it promises and delivers, but a

motorcycle, especially of a kind you’re meant to carve your touring dreams with, should feel interesting if not entirely enthralling. The Dominar simply doesn’t. It’s functional and well-suited to its purpose but, especially a decade into its existence, it’s hard to look past how dated and flavourless it feels. Time for a wake-up call, I suppose?

@TheMotorGram

Data service

Services output index will bolster data robustness

For a country where services accounts for 55 per cent of GDP, the need for a high frequency output indicator cannot be over-emphasised. The Index of Services Production, with 2024-25 as base year, has recently been unveiled on a trial basis to provide data each month, with a 60-day lag. Therefore, the data released on July 14, reflecting the performance of 19 sub-sectors, pertains to the year-on-year growth of services in April 2026.

As many as 14 of the 19 sectors recorded double-digit growth, with some sectors such as accommodation and food (37.2 per cent), retail trade (30.8 per cent), administrative and support services (28.7 per cent) and real estate (27.7 per cent) leading the growth surge. There are good reasons to run the ISP trials without being in a big hurry to bring it on stream. The April 2026 numbers are sharply higher than trend growth in services. The quarterly GDP data can remain the anchor for now. The ISP push has been propelled by the availability of high frequency GST data, the launch of the Annual Survey of Incorporated Service Sector Enterprises and the improvement in administrative databases (for sectors such as electricity, railways and mining) as a result of digitisation. At present, administrative data, high frequency entries as well as various surveys are in use. The accuracy of this index would depend on the robustness of GST data (a factor that came up with respect to the formulation of the new IIP), the accuracy of sector-specific deflators and the coverage of the unorganised sector.

To take the last point first, the ISP covers 60 per cent of the services sector in terms of types of business activities, but in terms of enterprises, nearly 50 per cent of services GVA has probably not been covered. The approach paper prepared for ISP says that the ‘temporary exclusion’ of health and education till Survey data comes on stream could account for 10 per cent of services GVA, while the rest of the enterprise exclusions could be in the region of 33 per cent. Other sectors that have been left out for now are public administration and defence, financial services other than banking and insurance, and a range of social work activities and personal services. The GST net should be expanded to make claims of ‘formalisation’ of the economy ring true.

ISP aims at using turnover (reliable in the case of services as they are immediately consumed with no inventory) and specific deflators. In some cases, volume based metrics may have to be used, such as, say, policies sold in the insurance sector. Deflators (input and output) are ideally meant to be derived from granular services PPI, but they are a work in progress. The ISP deflators for now are broad rather than specific — such as CPI (general) being applied to repair, banking and insurance and CPI (Services) being used for IT, R&D and administration. Much remains to be done. That said, the move to ISP, alongside a revamped WPI and IIP, marks a big data reform achievement.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

England’s World Cup disappointment
Historically, English football-supporting culture has had a well-known darker side. But in recent decades, as the England men’s team’s trophy drought has continued, some of its unofficial anthems have acquired an endearingly melancholy quality. “It was nearly complete, it was nearly so sweet”, as the Three Lions song had it in the 1990s, when England exited a World Cup and a European Championship at the semi-final stage. This summer, Oasis’s Wonderwall has been the soundtrack as Harry Kane and co progressed to Wednesday’s climactic semi-final showdown with Argentina. This is a song which, very wisely in an England context, puts a heavy emphasis on the idea of “maybe”. In the end it turned out to be maybe not. (LONDON, JULY 16)

GULF NEWS

The hard part of AI has arrived
In the UAE, artificial intelligence is no longer a future ambition. It is moving into the heart of government services, enterprise operations and everyday decision-making. The recent announcement that 50 per cent of government sectors, services and operations will transition to autonomous AI within two years is a clear signal of this shift. AI is no longer something institutions are testing, it is becoming part of how they function. This momentum is part of the UAE’s wider national agenda to position AI as a foundation for long-term growth, government transformation and digital competitiveness. But as adoption accelerates, the conditions around AI are also becoming more complex. (DUBAI, JULY 15)



Teaching a course on ‘Devolution, Development and Democracy’ at two institutions recently offered an opportunity to engage with young minds on governance and human development challenges at the last mile. After classroom discussions, students were sent to the field to observe the realities of urban governance first-hand. Their visits — to schools, Aanganwadi centres, health centres, municipal offices, collectorates, waste-to-wealth initiatives, and urban bastis — revealed an important paradox of contemporary urban India: infrastructure has expanded, but quality outcomes remain uneven. The students visited a large urban slum and a fast-urbanising district marked by large industrial activity. The challenge at the urban last mile is an amalgam of weak institutional design, fragmented accountability, and the absence of meaningful community engagement.

Water tankers do reach uncovered bastis. Yet, the absence of fixed timings or prior information means women still spend hours with large cans, leading to drudgery and serious health concerns. Schools have better physical infrastructure; sustainability of its maintenance remains a major concern. Dirty toilets, ill-maintained drinking water systems, uneven sports grounds without coaches, unclean classrooms, all convey issues beyond resource gaps. It is more a call for collaborative community action and institutional accountability through untied grants. Given challenges of unsatisfactory and overcrowded housing, there is a strong case for a secondary school to become a community learning centre, available to the children beyond schooling hours.

Many teachers are working hard, but excessive non-teaching responsibilities disrupt the momentum of teaching and learning. At the same time, there are instances where teacher accountability is very weak and Principals are helpless. Aanganwadis are providing an important service, but limited hour functioning makes them inadequate as a full-day childcare space. Public-private partnerships in waste-to-wealth have also reached smaller municipalities, often supported by technology-enabled monitoring systems. Here too, sustainability is a challenge as private partners are unsure of profits.

In bastis grappling with poor housing, inadequate sanitation and uncertain water availability, the presence of a local public clinic with a doctor, medicines, and diagnostic services is a strong felt need. Otherwise, even minor illnesses require residents to trudge miles to tertiary hospitals.



EMMANUAL YOGINI

The precarity of living in urban slums

LAST MILE DISCONNECT. Field visits reveal urban social infrastructure has improved, but does not deliver effectively. This is because citizens are not involved in governance

Urban localities with migrant populations have occupational health risks, poor housing conditions, and heightened susceptibility to communicable diseases. Fear of losing a day’s wages often delays treatment and diagnosis, aggravating the health conditions. A new approach to primary care is indeed needed. There is a need to embed public health thrust into mainstream municipal governance with collaborative citizen-centric governance.

FILLING INSTITUTIONAL GAPS
The field visits revealed the extraordinary resilience and enthusiasm of the local communities. It became clear that if they are trusted with responsibilities and made an integral part of the planning and decision-making process with untied funds, many of the last mile challenges can be tackled effectively. This process can further be enhanced with the support of professionals and dedicated civil society organisations working with communities at the last mile. Women’s collectives in a rural-urban

The challenge at the urban last mile is an amalgam of weak institutional design, fragmented accountability, and the absence of meaningful community engagement

settings presented some of the most positive examples encountered during the visits. Self-help groups (SHGs) have enabled savings, access to loans, and support during moments of crisis, while also creating spaces of trust, solidarity, and collective support for women. Further, participation in SHGs has increased women’s confidence, mobility, and leadership.

However, the limitations imposed by the patriarchy are starkly evident — continuing to shape and limit the emancipatory potential of SHGs because women’s participation, mobility, and financial autonomy often continue to be dependent on male approval within households. Many women described needing permission from husbands to attend meetings, travel to banks, or engage in economic activities, suggesting that agency remains conditional rather than fully autonomous.

The students also observed many examples of increasing technology use in service delivery. While this is a positive development, the field visits highlighted that in the absence of hand-holding at the community level and by treating technology as an end rather than a means to an end, exclusion becomes a challenge even when inclusion is the intent. Once again, a deeper community connect through collaborative governance will be essential in identifying solutions to the challenge.

THE ACCOUNTABILITY DEFICIT
These patterns point towards a larger

institutional problem: urban governance structures remain administratively present but distant from the communities most dependent on public services.

The larger challenge, however, lies in the structure of urban governance itself. Ward-level elected leaders are too distant from bastis or slums where communities on the fringe reside. Also, the wards are too large for meaningful collaborative action. The distance between the state and the basti weakens both effective oversight and trust. Effective governance requires elected leaders at the basti level. It is essential to revisit the institutional structure of governance to create community managed urban public services.

What emerged from the field visits was not an absence of citizen willingness, but a failure to build governance structures capable of working with communities as equal participants.

Viewed collectively, the field visits reconfirmed the precarity of living on the margins in urban slums. There is a need for an alternate paradigm of basti-centric collaborative governance. Devolved untied resources, professional support at the community level, and stronger voice and agency for women are essential.

The citizens are more than ready; is the state willing to recast its role? That is the question.

Sinha and Suryam work at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress. While the views are personal, they acknowledge the insights of the students

It’s time to teach AI to listen and perceive

The next decade of industry will be owned by nations whose machines have foresight, which comes with listening

Prateek Mital

Billions of dollars are pouring into AI in India. Google alone has pledged \$15 billion. But look closely at what that money buys: data centres, chips, cloud. It is all compute. Just this week, IBM’s stock suffered its worst single-day fall in history down 25 per cent because its corporate customers diverted their budgets to AI servers and memory chips. The gold rush is so fixated on computing power that it is swallowing everything else in enterprise technology. Yet almost nobody in Big Tech is spending a rupee teaching AI to hear.

Why does that matter? Start with your car.

You know your car is in trouble before your car does. A new rattle. A change in the engine’s hum. A squeal when you brake. Your car catches the problem weeks before the dashboard light comes on. The light is just a machine’s late confession. The sound was the truth and it arrived first.

Now here is the uncomfortable part. The artificial intelligence we are building to run our factories, drive our vehicles, and power our robots cannot

hear that sound at all. Today’s AI is astonishing at language and images. It can write your emails and paint you a picture. Why? Because it was trained on the internet with decades of our text, photos, and videos. That was the data lying around, so that became the AI’s entire picture of the world. But the internet is only the part of reality humans chose to type, photograph, and upload. Everything else, the hum of a healthy motor, the shudder of a failing pump, the heat of an overloaded wire never made it online. Nobody posts vibrations.

STRANGE KIND OF INTELLIGENCE
So we have built machines with a strange kind of intelligence: they have read everything and felt nothing.

This was fine when AI lived inside chatbots. It is not fine now. The next wave, call it Physical AI, is supposed to walk into the real world: robots on factory floors, machines that fix other machines, systems that keep power grids and water plants running. We are sending them in with a map of reality drawn entirely from the internet.

And here is the part Big Tech has not fully confronted. The enterprise money it is chasing sits in factories, refineries,



NEXT. AI must walk into the real world

railways, and power plants and none of those use cases work without the messy, physical layer. A chatbot can summarise a maintenance report; it cannot tell you the compressor will seize on Thursday. For that, AI must live where the machine lives: in vibration, sound, pressure, heat, and current. If the giants want the industrial enterprise to pay for AI, they will have to leave the clean world of text and pixels and learn the grimy dialect of the shop floor. The companies that skip this step will keep selling copilots; the ones that master it will sell something factories will actually fight to buy — foresight.

A failing bearing whispers its warning

thousands of times in that same second. Record too slowly and the warning doesn’t blur it vanishes. Record everything and you drown in data too vast to store or send. So the sensor itself must be smart enough to decide, in the moment, which whisper matters.

The fix is not to abandon digital computing it remains unbeatable for learning and planning. The fix is to start listening where the world actually speaks. Put intelligence next to the sensor. Catch the tremor while it is still a tremor.

For India, which wants to be the world’s factory floor and whose economy runs on pumps, motors, looms and lathes, this is not academic. The nation that teaches machines to listen will own the next decade of industry. The ones still scraping the internet for text will be photographing the smoke after the fire.

Physical AI will not be limited by how much it can compute. It will be limited by how much of the world it can perceive. And right now, our smartest machines are brilliant, well-read and deaf.

The writer is General Manager & Head - AI Lab, Hitachi India

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Effective use of AI

With reference to ‘AI is no magic wand’ (July 17), it is true that technology improves productivity only when it is well integrated through the entire business architecture, from the floor to the boardroom (management). AI is no exception. The Generative AI era is only a few years old and it takes time for businesses to adopt the technology and redesign the business processes. Government needs to help MSMEs by incentivising AI adoption: implementing expenses may be subsidised along with facilitating skilling of their workforce and help

them with pre-designed AI tools for faster adoption. However, encouraging businesses to use AI effectively should not preclude the country from developing frontier AI, as continued dependency on foreign AI companies could be a threat to India’s healthcare, military systems, other critical infrastructure. **Kosaraju Chandramouli** Hyderabad

Attrition in private banks

It is disheartening to note that leading private sector banks in India going digital rapidly, and lessening their workforce. Their view that automation will improve customer

service, reduce costs and enhance sales is unacceptable, to say the least. They should spare a thought for labour, which is a living factor of production. It is imperative that both the public and private sectors in this part of the world use labour-intensive technology and optimise human welfare. **S Ramakrishnasayee** Chennai

Ensuring price stability

Apropos ‘Inflated worries’ (July 17). The Reserve Bank is right in examining core inflation and the evolving global developments before reacting to short-term price

movements. However, policymakers should remain alert to the impact of food, fuel and transport costs on ordinary households. Strengthening supply chains, improving agricultural storage, reducing logistics costs and ensuring timely market interventions can help contain inflation without hurting economic growth. At the same time, fiscal discipline and prudent monetary policy must work together. A balanced, data-driven approach will preserve price stability while supporting investment, employment and consumer confidence. **A Myilsami** Coimbatore, TN

Ethanol-blended fuel

The government has raised the petrol-ethanol blend ratio to 80:20 for retail sales, amidst the simmering West Asia war. The biofuel is subject to a GST of 5 per cent, providing an additional revenue stream for the government. Oil marketing companies sell blended fuel to consumers at retail prices equivalent to that of regular petrol. The government has admitted E20 fuel may reduce fuel efficiency by 3-5 per cent. This means more petrol for the same level of usage, and more cost to the user. **Haridasan Rajan** Kozhikode, Kerala



QUICKLY.

MakeMyTrip files confidential IPO papers



Mumbai: MakeMyTrip (MMT) has confidentially pre-filed a draft red herring prospectus with SEBI for an initial public offering of its Indian subsidiary, the company said. The Nasdaq-listed MMT plans to list shares at the stock exchanges through an offer for sale route. The company expects the proposed listing to enhance its brand visibility and support its ability to incentivise and promote talent in a competitive technology recruitment landscape. “The net proceeds received by MMT and ibibo Holdings from the sale of shares in MMT India will further strengthen the cash position of MMT and are expected to be utilised for long term growth, inorganic initiatives and repurchases of different classes of securities,” it said. **OUR BUREAU**

AMFI eases transmission process for legal heirs

New Delhi: The Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) on Friday simplified the process for transmission of mutual fund units following the death of an investor, after a directive from SEBI aimed at making claims easier for nominees and legal heirs. The revised procedure, which takes immediate effect, seeks to reduce document related hurdles by addressing common issues such as mismatches in the deceased investor’s address, name and signature. SEBI advised AMFI to further simplify the standards governing the “Procedure to Claim Units/Proceeds upon death of a unit holder” to address operational challenges faced by the families of deceased investors. **PTI**

BROKER’S CALL.

Mirae Asset Sharekhan

HDFC LIFE INSURANCE (BUY)
Target: ₹715
CMP: ₹563.55
Gross written premium rose 15 per cent y-o-y to ₹17,168 crores, driven by a robust 19 per cent y-o-y growth in renewal premium collections to ₹9,020 crore. The company reported a 7 per cent y-o-y growth in Individual APE at ₹2,969 crore, while Total APE grew 9 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,515 crore. This growth was underpinned by strong customer acquisition, with the number of policies growing in double digits and outpacing the industry. New business margin remained stable at 25 per cent, slightly moderating from 25.1 per cent y-o-y. However, q-o-q, it was up 100 bps q-o-q. If the residual GST impact of approximately 60 basis points is excluded, the underlying NBM actually expanded to 25.6 per cent. The company’s product mix remained well-diversified, with ULIPs constituting 44 per cent of individual APE and non-PAR savings improving to 22 per cent. For FY27, management is prioritising top-line and VNB growth over margin expansion, intentionally keeping margins rangebound at about 25 per cent by reinvesting gains back into the business. Supported by deep penetration in Tier 2/3 markets and an expected volume recovery in the bancassurance channel (esp. from HDFC Bank), the long-term growth trajectory remains highly visible. We fine tune our estimates and value the stock at around 1.9x FY28 EV to arrive at revised target price of ₹715 and maintain Buy rating.

Anand Rathi

SOUTH INDIAN BANK (BUY)
Target: ₹61
CMP: ₹44.62
South Indian Bank delivered a healthy performance for another quarter, with continued improvement in growth, profitability and asset quality. Credit growth accelerated to 18.6 per cent y-o-y in Q1FY27 (compared to 15.8 per cent in Q4FY26), led by strong traction in RAM segment, while improving CASA mix lifted the CASA ratio to 33 per cent. NIM witnessed a sharp sequential expansion by 28 bps to 3.23 per cent, driven by lower funding costs. Looking ahead, margin are expected to remain broadly stable, as an improving retail/MSME mix offsets the pricing pressure. Despite lower treasury income, profitability remained healthy, with RoA sustaining above 1 per cent for the ninth consecutive quarter, supported by steady operating performance and moderate credit cost. Asset quality continued to remain healthy, with gross slippages moderating to 52bps. Steady moderation in slippages and healthy recoveries underscore the resilience of the bank’s loan book. Notably, we do not expect any material impact on the bank’s book due to transition to ECL. We expect the bank to sustain mid-teen loan growth and deliver RoA/RoE of about 1.1/13 per cent over FY27-28e. We maintain Buy rating on the stock with a 12-month TP of ₹61, valuing it at 1.1x FY28e P/ABV. **Key Risks:** Higher stress in corporate book; lower recoveries and lower-than-expected loan growth.

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Consultation paper on PMS regulatory overhaul to be out very soon: SEBI

STEPPING UP VIGIL. Executive Director Manoj Kumar flags ‘sort of front-running’ instances in industry

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India consultation paper to review the regulatory framework for the portfolio management services (PMS) industry is being finalised and will be out “very soon”, its Executive Director Manoj Kumar told *businessline* on the sidelines of an event here on Friday. The use of advanced technologies like AI is also helping the regulator identify patterns and flag a few instances of “sort of front-running” in the PMS industry,” the ED said. “All these regulations were designed at some point of time. Now, business has gone up over a period of

time. So there is a huge expectation that regulation should also align itself to the changes,” he said. However, he declined to confirm if the limit of ₹50 lakh mandated by SEBI as minimum investment for PMS will see any change.

FRONT-RUNNING ALERT
On front-running, Kumar said, “What I have flagged to the industry is that we are getting some instances where we feel that something similar to front-running is happening. So my job as a regulator is to tell the industry that this is not a right practice and we have to rectify it,” he said. The decision on how to rectify it is a call that will be made going forward, he added.



KEY ADDRESS. Manoj Kumar, Executive Director, SEBI, addressing the ‘PMS Leadership Conclave 2026’, hosted by the Association of Portfolio Managers in India, in Chennai on Friday

He was in Chennai as the chief guest for the ‘PMS Leadership Conclave 2026’ hosted by the Association of Portfolio Managers in India (APMI), the representative body of SEBI-registered

portfolio managers. The event brought together regulators, portfolio managers, distributors, family offices and wealth management professionals to discuss the sector’s evolving priorities

Sensex, Nifty end in green despite global gloom

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The benchmarks closed sharply higher on Friday, shrugging off weak global cues as buying in banking, IT and financial heavyweights drove a broad-based rally. The gains came even as the escalating conflict between the US and Iran pushed Brent crude above \$85 a barrel and gold wobbled near \$4,000 an ounce, keeping inflation concerns alive globally. The Nifty 50 rose 1.09 per cent to settle at 24,334, while the Sensex advanced 1.25 per cent to close at 78,151. For the week, the Nifty ended 0.53 per cent higher and Sensex 0.75 per cent. However, the Nifty Midcap 100 and Smallcap 100 declined 0.41 per cent and 0.21 per cent respectively, reflecting selective profit-booking outside the index heavyweights.

Global stocks were at the receiving end, with Korea’s Kospi and Japan Nikkei’s falling 6.37 per cent and 4 per cent. European stocks were also ruling largely negative by 0.5 per cent.

IT STAR PERFORMER

IT was the standout sectoral winner of the week, surging 4.2 per cent, lifted by better-than-expected results from Tech Mahindra. Private banks also gained on expectations that an RBI special overseas deposit scheme could pull in around \$30 billion from NRIs, bolstering forex reserves. Pharma, metals and realty were the week’s laggards. Investor attention next week will be firmly on earnings. Siddhartha Khemka of Motilal Oswal expects “a gradual uptrend” driven by the earnings season, though crude at elevated levels and rupee weakness remain key risks to watch.

NLC India Renewables appoints book running lead managers for IPO

Our Bureau
New Delhi

NLC India Renewables (NIRL) said on Friday that it has appointed four leading investment banking institutions as the book running lead managers (BRLMs) for its proposed initial public offering (IPO). NIRL is the green energy arm of lignite miner NLC India. The proposed IPO is expected to strengthen NIRL’s capital base and support its long-term growth strategy in the renewable energy sector and to contribute to the country’s target of achieving

500 gigawatt (GW) of non-fossil fuel-based energy capacity by 2030, NIRL said. Besides, it is intended to facilitate the listing of the equity shares of NIRL on the recognised stock exchanges, subject to receipt of applicable statutory and regulatory approvals and prevailing market conditions, it added. The selection process of BRLMs was carried out in accordance with the framework and evaluation methodology approved by the board and was conducted through a structured, transparent and competitive process. SBI Capital Markets, IIFL Capital Services, IDBI Cap-

ital Markets & Securities and HDFC Bank are the four merchant bankers appointed as BRLMs by NIRL.

IPO PROCESS
The appointment of the BRLMs marks an important milestone in NIRL’s proposed listing process. The BRLMs shall advise and assist the Company in the preparation and management of the IPO, including undertaking due diligence, preparation of offer documents, coordination with regulatory authorities and intermediaries, marketing of the issue, and other activities in accordance with applicable laws and regulations.

5paisa Capital pivots to higher-value clients as F&O slowdown weighs on growth

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Online brokerage 5paisa Capital is focusing on increasing business from existing customers rather than chasing account openings as subdued trading activity in the futures and options (F&O) segment continues to weigh on the industry. It reported a 14 per cent y-o-y rise in revenue to ₹88.4 crore for the June quarter, while profit after tax came in at ₹11.4 crore. The management said market volatility and lower trading activity led to a mod-

eration in growth during the quarter, but said customer engagement and funding balances continued to improve. “Our average client funding book... increased 10 per cent QOQ to ₹422 crore. This basically represents that it is not just user acquisition, but also wallet deepening that we are focused on,” MD and CEO Gaurav Seth said during the earnings call. **F&O IMPACT** “There was a little bit of moderation because of the volatility... We expect growth to accelerate from the current base,” Seth said. The comments come at a



Gaurav Seth, MD and CEO, 5paisa Capital

time when the online brokerage industry is grappling with lower derivatives volumes after regulatory measures introduced last year reduced speculative trading in the F&O segment. Several listed brokers have

have seen pressure on trading activity and transaction revenues in recent quarters. The company said it is deploying capital raised through its ₹468 crore rights issue to strengthen the business. Of the proceeds, ₹227 crore has been used to meet higher margin requirements, ₹150 crore to repay borrowings and ₹88 crore for general corporate purposes. Going forward, 5paisa plans to expand its margin funding products, increase the number of stocks covered under its funding offerings and roll out a revamped trading platform over the next few months.

The IPO paradox: Why bigger isn’t always better

RINGSIDE VIEW.

KS BADRI NARAYANAN

The recent performance of some of the world’s biggest initial public offerings (IPOs) raises an important question: Are investors getting carried away by size and hype while overlooking fundamentals? The world’s largest IPO — SpaceX’s \$75 billion share sale — made a spectacular debut but has since slipped below its IPO price of \$135. After surging to a high of \$225.65 within days of listing, the stock has been on a steady decline, touching a low of \$130.74 on Thursday. Whether it has found its bottom remains uncertain. A similar pattern emerged with SK Hynix, whose \$26.5 billion Nasdaq listing became the largest-ever US IPO by a foreign company and the second-largest share sale on Wall Street after SpaceX. The stock, issued at \$149 on July 9, climbed to \$194.45 before retreating sharply. It

was trading at \$152.31, only marginally above its issue price.

SIZE VS RETURNS
Despite their massive valuations, these offerings had little difficulty attracting investors. SpaceX reportedly received bids worth nearly \$150 billion, driven largely by institutional investors. SK Hynix’s IPO, meanwhile, was subscribed more than seven times, reflecting strong investor appetite for one of the world’s leading memory-chip makers. Until recently, mega IPOs were relatively rare. Before SpaceX, Saudi Aramco held the record with its \$25.6 billion public issue. Investors who subscribed at the IPO price of 32 Saudi riyals are unlikely to be pleased today. The stock currently trades around SAR 26, well below its issue price, despite having touched a lifetime high of SAR 39.40.

INDIA: A SIMILAR STORY
The experience in India has been no different. Hyundai Motor India’s ₹27,870-crore IPO — the country’s largest

The big and not so beautiful

Global	IPO size (\$ billion)	IPO price	Current price
SpaceX	75	\$135	\$123*
SK Hynix	26.5	\$149	\$154*
Aramco (Saudi Arabia)	25.6	SAR32	SAR26.68
Softbank	21.3	¥1500	¥5424
Visa	17.9	\$44	\$365.14
India	IPO size (₹ cr)	IPO price (₹)	Current price (₹)
Hyundai Motor India	27,859	1,960	1,992.25
LIC**	20,557	474.5*	433.3
Paytm	18,300	2,150	1,348.55
Tata Capital	15,512	326	354
Coal India	15,199	245	427.6
** Offered ₹45 discount to retail investors over IPO price of ₹949			
*Adjusted for 1:1 bonus #at 9 pm IST			

to date — was priced at ₹1,960 a share. While the stock briefly rallied to ₹2,890, it has since settled around ₹2,000, leaving long-term investors with only modest gains. The ₹21,008-crore IPO of the Life Insurance Corporation of India has also delivered little by way of meaningful returns since listing. Paytm, whose ₹18,300-crore issue ranks among India’s biggest, continues to trade well below its IPO price of ₹2,150, eroding significant investor wealth. And then there was Reli-

ance Power’s blockbuster IPO in 2008. The less said about what followed, the better. Of course, not every large IPO disappoints. Companies such as Meta (formerly Facebook), Visa and SoftBank have rewarded investors handsomely over the long term, underscoring that execution — not merely scale — ultimately determines success. **BEYOND EUPHORIA** A successful IPO is only the beginning of a company’s journey. What matters more

is the quality of management and its ability to navigate economic cycles, technological disruption, rising competition and unforeseen crises. Strong leadership, disciplined capital allocation and consistent execution are what create lasting shareholder value. For investors, the lesson is equally clear. IPO decisions should not be driven by the size of the issue or listing-day excitement. Valuation, corporate governance, cash-flow generation, competitive positioning and long-term growth prospects deserve far greater attention. Companies, too, have a role to play. IPOs that are priced reasonably, leaving meaningful upside for investors while maintaining high standards of governance and transparency, are far more likely to build lasting trust than those that maximise valuations at the time of listing. Ultimately, an IPO should mark the beginning of wealth creation — not merely the transfer of wealth from new investors to existing shareholders.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 261.55 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Reliance Ind	1327.20	45.15	18.76	8.05	
ICICI Bank	1444.30	40.84	17.88	9.29	
HDFC Bank	619.60	37.79	15.93	11.26	
Kotak Bank	389.95	20.58	20.11	2.58	
TCS	2269.00	15.16	16.40	2.08	
Axis Bank	1328.50	13.11	15.56	3.42	
M&M	3179.20	11.97	21.23	2.55	
State Bank	1044.30	11.83	11.12	3.87	
Bajaj Finance	1056.30	10.95	34.02	2.54	
Infosys	1096.50	10.94	22.16	3.45	
L&T	3814.50	9.94	27.69	4.01	
Hind Unilever	2143.80	8.80	47.60	1.71	
Tech Mahindra	1572.90	8.68	32.08	0.90	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	242.98	5.25	102.79	0.72	
Eicher Motors	7563.50	4.36	37.64	0.94	
HCL Tech	1203.90	3.80	18.74	1.14	
JSW Steel	1237.30	3.34	11.86	1.04	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1034.90	3.21	24.29	1.30	
Grasim Ind	3109.70	3.03	20.55	1.05	
ITC	280.70	2.84	16.73	2.43	
PowerGrid Corp	283.55	2.77	16.56	1.15	
Bajaj Auto	10443.00	2.70	27.60	1.04	
Bajaj Finserv	1854.00	1.95	15.09	0.96	
Bharat Elec	409.45	1.84	49.37	1.32	
Adani Ports	1837.40	1.77	33.12	1.22	
Tata Motors PV	335.60	1.73	4119.86	0.63	
Asian Paints	2689.00	1.41	58.69	1.09	
Titan	4638.10	1.11	81.15	1.72	
SBI Life	1829.40	0.72	74.29	0.74	
Tata Steel	105.89	0.72	21.32	1.98	
Adani Enter	3160.70	0.59	41.32	0.82	
NestleIndia	1427.20	0.58	78.65	0.92	
Maruti Suzuki	13803.00	0.57	29.56	1.62	
ONGC	247.29	0.46	6.25	0.86	
Eternal Ltd.	286.60	0.24	755.68	1.86	
Coal India	427.65	0.21	8.05	0.92	
TataConsumerProduct	1088.60	0.01	69.65	0.64	
NTPC	341.85	-0.62	12.03	1.45	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5248.50	-0.84	0.00	1.07	
HDFC Life	563.65	-0.93	63.60	0.54	
Wipro	176.00	-1.09	13.94	0.45	
UltraTech Cement	1127.30	-1.14	42.20	1.25	
Trent Ltd.	2942.40	-1.29	88.05	0.75	
Cipla	1418.70	-1.33	28.68	0.82	
Max Healthcare	1089.90	-1.35	73.54	0.73	
Apollo Hosp	8826.00	-1.39	63.37	0.82	
Dr Reddys Lab	1211.20	-1.76	24.32	0.66	
Sun Pharma	1932.60	-4.05	40.29	1.84	
Hindalco	944.15	-4.79	15.84	1.23	
Bharti Airtel	1908.80	-8.63	34.39	5.21	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 68.35 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3618.20	37.34	53.95	3.44	
HindustanAeronautics	4500.70	36.88	33.02	3.45	
DF	667.80	36.73	37.44	1.73	
Britannia Ind	5412.50	34.92	51.39	2.58	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1722.60	31.59	86.48	2.29	
Hdfc Amc	2651.20	29.03	39.76	2.19	
Bpcl	315.55	20.91	5.30	2.59	
Rural Elec	355.10	19.96	5.73	1.79	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1804.90	19.86	29.41	3.16	
Godrej Consumer	1071.80	16.58	58.92	1.74	
Power Finance	404.85	14.81	3.97	1.58	
Adani Motors Crv	414.65	12.75	50.43	3.50	
Ambuja Cements	438.50	8.88	19.82	1.11	
MacroTech Developers .	1188.75	8.59	34.62	1.33	
Tata Capital	354.20	7.09	30.74	0.72	
SarmavardhersonInternatll	144.17	6.88	37.24	2.58	
Pidilind	1556.10	5.85	64.51	1.92	
Punjab Natli Bank	105.77	5.50	6.58	1.47	
Solar Industries	18467.00	4.74	96.22	1.82	
LtImidtree	4075.60	4.13	23.26	1.53	
Tata Power	377.25	0.73	23.56	2.55	
AvenueSuper	3951.90	0.47	84.30	2.58	
Siemens	3658.80	0.31	85.01	1.21	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	88.41	0.00	16.48	0.72	
Indian OilCorp	141.69	-1.19	4.58	2.14	
Union Bank	168.46	-1.74	6.62	1.32	
MuthootFin	2989.50	-2.06	11.32	1.30	
Bajaj Holdings	10398.00	-2.39	11.82	1.82	
Jindal Steel	1025.00	-3.23	31.11	1.54	
Gail (India)	171.20	-4.00	14.85	1.87	
Mazagon Dock	2342.80	-4.08	34.30	0.72	
United Spirits .	1375.80	-4.98	53.60	1.64	
Hindus Zinc	518.35	-5.03	15.83	1.01	
Siemens Energy India .	3385.50	-5.09	92.05	1.21	
Boch	40855.00	-6.43	43.45	1.43	
Zyklusfisciences	1143.15	-7.14	38.85	2.49	
Bank Of Baroda	246.80	-0.89	6.36	1.85	
Canara Bank	125.01	-0.66	6.34	1.70	
Indian Hotels Co .	727.90	-9.06	46.11	2.59	
Varun Beverages .	463.35	-12.71	48.83	2.56	
Hyundai Motor India .	1993.30	-13.14	29.82	1.15	
Shree Cement	26515.00	-18.85	54.79	1.43	
Vedanta	235.05	-23.90	6.24	1.74	
Abbi India	7506.00	-24.63	100.66	1.59	
Divis Lab	7247.50	-25.30	74.92	3.73	
Adani Power .	214.45	-25.56	31.88	3.60	
AdaniGreenenergy	1513.90	-29.03	125.50	2.05	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	905.00	-33.78	119.10	2.51	
CumminsIndia	5663.00	-33.14	23.29	2.98	
Torrent Pharma	4763.00	-95.74	84.74	2.83	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Gold eyes biggest weekly dip in 6 months on inflation



Gold held steady on Friday, but was on track for its biggest weekly loss in six weeks as escalating US-Iran tensions fuelled inflation fears and reinforcing expectations of US interest rate hikes. Spot gold was unchanged at \$3,970.35 per ounce by 1332 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery fell 0.5 per cent to \$3,973.10. REUTERS

Copper falls as W. Asia crisis weighs on demand

Copper prices fell as escalating tensions in West Asia spurred inflation concerns and cast a shadow over the demand outlook for industrial metals. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was down 1.4 per cent at \$13,410 a tonne. Aluminium fell 1.2 per cent to \$3,146; nickel lost 1.7 per cent to \$16,860. REUTERS

Palm oil posts second consecutive weekly gain



Jakarta: Malaysian palm oil futures rose for a second straight week on Friday despite being dragged down by weakness in Dalian vegetable oil prices. The benchmark palm oil contract for October delivery on the BMD Exchange was down 12 ringgit at 4,594 ringgit (\$1,123.23) a tonne. REUTERS

Urad prices surge on fears of kharif output fall

AIDING UPTREND. The pulse trend turns bullish on tight supply concerns, demand rebound and rise in Myanmar, Brazil prices

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Urad (black matpe) leads the firm trend in prices of pulses on tight supplies, a rebound in demand and concerns over deficit rain affecting kharif sowing. The all-India average wholesale *mandi* prices of urad, as collated by the Agriculture Ministry on the UPAG portal, have increased by about 20 per cent over the past month, while the trend in other pulses varieties has been mixed. The price rise in urad is due to a range of factors such as the demand-supply gap, rebound in demand, rise in prices in origins such as Myanmar and Brazil, a weaker currency and partially due to the fears of deficit rain hurting the kharif sowing, according to B Krishna Murthy of Four P International, an



WEATHER WOES. With yields being lower in other key producing countries such as Myanmar and Brazil, due to the impact of adverse climate, prices have moved up in these origins

importer in Chennai. The sowing of urad as of July 17 was 13.51 lakh hectares — nearly 6 per cent lower than the same period last year.

OUTPUT DOWN India's urad production was down last year (2025-26) at 21.60 lakh tonnes (lt) from 22.42 lt the previous year, resulting in tight supplies.

Firm trend		
	June 15, 2026	July 15, 2026
Urad	7,683.26	9,212.41
Tur	7,468.44	7,599.94
Moong	7,031.74	6,817.34
Gram	5,628.24	5,772.79
Lentil	6,751.76	7,605.21

With yields being lower in other key producing countries such as Myanmar and Brazil, due to the impact of adverse climate, prices have moved up in the origins in the recent past. The trade in these countries knows that India has a shortfall in urad crop, said Rahul Chauhan of IGrain India. The CNF prices for Myanmar origin black matpe for July delivery in Chennai, which stood at \$825 per tonne for the fair average quality 2026 crop on June 15,

have now increased to \$935. Similarly, superior quality 2026 is now quoting at \$1,030 per tonne against \$905 a month ago, per the data from India Pulses & Grains Association. “The yield in Myanmar is down by 30 per cent as per trade estimates. The 2025 Myanmar crop, which was about 1 million tonnes, is certainly not more than 7 lakh tonnes this year as the crop had suffered yield loss due to the yellow mosaic virus disease,” said Krishnamurthy. Similarly, in Brazil, the trade was estimating a production of about 4.5 lt, but now fear it is down to 3 lt, because of the unfavourable climate he said.

RABI CROP LOSS Also, rabi crop in Andhra faced a yield loss of around 15-20 per cent, and the crop this year was picked up by

some 6-7 northern States, which was quite unusual, resulting in reduced stocks, Krishnamurthy said. “On top of all this, El Nino has started playing out, but even then people are not carrying stocks. People, who had suffered losses in the past couple of years, are just running hand-to-mouth,” he said. **LOWER IMPORTS** Per the import data from the Department of Commerce, compiled by the India Pulses and Grains Association, urad imports during the January-May period of calendar 2026 stood at 2.93 lt, lower than 3.83 lt a year ago. Imports from Myanmar stood at 2.35 lt during January-May and from Brazil at 37,780 tonnes. Urad imports from Thailand stood at 11,228 tonnes and other origins were 8,124 tonnes.

FPOs want to be treated like farmers, not corporates

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Even as FPOs are waiting to get declared “deemed *mandis*” by the States to help them independently carry out buying and selling activities, some of the representatives have demanded that the farmer collectives should at least be considered as ‘farmer’. This is because the profit is shared among shareholder-farmers unlike a private company, though registered under companies law. Such a national policy will help them from paying *mandi* fees and income tax. Though some States have allowed free trading outside *mandi* premises, a few like

Uttar Pradesh charge *mandi* fee and other levies to the tune of 1.5 per cent on essential items like onion, tomato, potato, lemon, green chilli and ginger in the fruits and vegetable category. The fee is collected even if the trading happens outside the agriculture market yard.

A WAY OUT? “If FPOs are allowed exemption from *mandi* fees, they can directly sell outside the state and that will help farmers realise about ₹150/quintal more on groundnut,” said Sanjay Gupta, CEO of Ramraj FPO, Jhansi (Uttar Pradesh). Nitin Puri, CEO of KisaanSay, said most of the products his company directly sourcing from partner FPOs. But, instead of buying



raw material in bulk, KisaanSay has turned these FPOs into primary processors through handholding. “We have got them all necessary legal compliances like FSSAI and GST registration as a result we are not worried on *mandi* fee.” But Deepak Kumar of Sambhal Swarnim Potato FPO of Moradabad district in Uttar Pradesh, said the gov-

The demand comes even as they await to be declared as ‘deemed mandis’ by the States

ernment should treat FPOs differently from any private company. Even for any subsidy, it is the same as what any private company receives. “*Mandi* fees and other levies in Uttar Pradesh should be made zero for FPOs when we directly collect the farmers’ produce and sell it and already some States have allowed this,” Kumar said and wondered why only essential fruits and vegetables in UP are taxed in

the F&V category. Sources said that market fee at 1 per cent and development Cess at 0.5 per cent is levied on potato, onion, tomato, lemon, green chilli and ginger whether traded inside or outside *mandis*. Besides, 3 per cent charges are collected by commission agents when buying-selling happens in these six items within the agriculture market yard. **NO FEE MANDIS** West Bengal, Rajasthan, Odisha, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Jharkhand, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Assam and Andhra Pradesh do not charge any fee in fruits and vegetables (F&V) when trading happens outside *mandi* complex. States such as Chhattis-

garh, Assam, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Odisha and West Bengal do not levy any fee or cess on F&V trading even inside *mandis*. But Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan, Punjab, Karnataka, Gujarat, Haryana, Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh levy fee or cess or both up to 2 per cent. In Himachal Pradesh, only apple is taxed at 1 per cent both within and outside *mandis*. Similarly, in Madhya Pradesh, banana and orange attract *mandi* fee. The commission fee charged by commission agents and fixed by the State government varies — between 2 per cent in Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh and 6 per cent in Maharashtra, Rajasthan and Delhi.

Research documentary highlights the decline of India’s indigenous cattle

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Bean Extracts has released *Hasanand*, a researched documentary examining the changing relationship between India’s indigenous cattle, agriculture and the rural economy. The 14.51-minute-long documentary explores the economic, social and agricultural factors behind the decline of desi cows and what it means for the future of India’s farming ecosystem. The Bean Extracts is the documentary division of Fin-Bean Media, which focuses on research-driven films on the people, industries and ideas shaping India. Per a media statement, *Hasanand* asks the question why the desi cow continues to lose ground on farms despite cattle protection be-



coming a policy priority at both the Centre and in several States. “The film is rooted in the work being done at Hasanand Gau Samvardhan Kendra, but we used that as a way to ask a larger question: Why is the desi cow disappearing, and what does that mean for farmers and the rural economy?” said Suyash Maheshwari, Founder of The Bean Extracts and FinBean Media.

BEYOND PROTECTION KML Pathak, Secretary of the MVH Gochar Bhumi Trust, said the objective of the Hasanand Gau Samvardhan Kendra has never been limited to protecting cows. “The larger purpose is to rebuild an ecosystem where the desi cow can again have a meaningful place in farming, rural life and the farmer’s

economy. Many conversations around desi cows become either emotional or religious, but this film has tried to examine the issue with greater depth. What I appreciated about Suyash and his team was that they spent time understanding why this work matters, what has changed for farmers and what needs to be rebuilt. *Hasanand* presents our work as part of a much larger conversation, and that is what makes the film important for us,” he said. The statement said *Hasanand* seeks to understand the realities surrounding indigenous cattle, modern agriculture and the economics shaping rural India. It combines on-ground storytelling with expert insights to encourage informed public discussion on an issue that affects millions of rural livelihoods.

GOLDEN FIBRE



PRICE BOOST. Workers carry freshly harvested jute in Nadia district, West Bengal. Jute acreage has increased to 6.28 lakh hectares as of July 7 from 6.16 lakh hectares a year ago, encouraged by prices that more than doubled to ₹14,408 a quintal in the first week of July 2026.

West Asia crisis hits orthodox tea exports from Kochi auctions

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

A subdued export demand continues to weigh on orthodox tea sales at the Kochi auctions, amid the escalating conflict in West Asia. Traders said exports are currently limited to Europe and Russia, while shipments to GCC and other West Asian markets have largely come to a standstill. Rising freight charges, shipment delays and uncertainty at ports have prompted exporters to put tea purchases on hold, they added. The weak demand was reflected in sale 29, where nearly 19 per cent of the offered quantity of 2,69,479 kg of orthodox tea remained unsold. The average price also de-



clined by ₹3 to ₹183 a kg from ₹186 in the previous week. Auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said select-grade whole leaf teas witnessed strong demand, with prices appreciating by ₹10-15 a kg and, in some cases, even more. CTC leaf prices were firm to dearer, with 96 per cent of the offered quantity of 29,593 kg sold. **QUALITY BREWS** Anil George Joseph, Presid-

ent of the Tea Trade Association of Cochin, said the market continued to reflect stable demand for quality teas, with buying remaining selective amid cautious trade sentiment. Better quality teas continued to command firm prices, while secondary and plainer grades faced resistance, reflecting the prevailing domestic and export demand dynamics. The CTC dust market witnessed good demand, with good liquoring teas and popular Kerala marks ruling steady to firm and, at times, dearer. Of the 7,29,953 kg offered, 86 per cent was sold. The orthodox dust market was firm to dearer, with the entire offered quantity of 9,298 kg sold. Exporters were the principal buyers.

Health buzz revives demand for indigenous superfruits

Jamun, Manila tamarind gain fresh appeal as consumers seek natural remedies for diabetes

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Jamun (Indian blackberry) and Manila tamarind, known as *junglele jangri* in Hindi, *kodukapuli* in Tamil and *seema chintakaya* in Telugu, are making a quiet comeback after decades of neglect, riding a wave of consumer interest in indigenous foods and their health benefits. From roadside fruit stalls in Chennai to market streets in Tamil Nadu’s Cauvery delta, these once-overlooked seasonal fruits are commanding premium prices and attracting health-conscious buyers. “There is good demand for jamun during the season. People stop their cars and buy 250 or 500 g even



though it costs around ₹250 a kg,” said B Govindraj, who sells fruits near Murugappa Polytechnic in Avadi, a Chennai suburb. Nearly 300 km away in Mayiladuthurai, R Kalanjianathan is witnessing a similar trend with Manila tamarind. “I sell at least 10 kg a day at around ₹280 a kg during the peak season. Towards the end of the season, prices touch nearly ₹400 a kg,” he said. Both source the fruits



from Andhra Pradesh, though they are also cultivated in Tamil Nadu. **HEALTH BENEFITS** Scientists say growing awareness about the nutritional and medicinal properties of these fruits has transformed them from wild, neglected produce into sought-after seasonal delicacies. “These fruits possess health benefits that were never commercially tapped until a few years ago.

As people have become more conscious about their well-being, they are making a comeback,” said R Nagjothi, Assistant Professor of Crop Physiology at the SRM College of Agricultural Sciences (SRMCAS). According to M Jawaharlal, Dean of SRMCAS, jamun is rich in potassium, fibre and antioxidants, helping regulate blood sugar, improve digestion and address nutrient deficiencies. Its seeds have long been used in traditional medicine for their anti-inflammatory properties. Manila tamarind is equally prized for its medicinal value. “It is known to help manage diabetes and is rich in vitamin C and antioxidants. It supports immunity, bone health and

oral health,” Jawaharlal said. B Gopu, Associate Professor in the Department of Fruit Science at SRMCAS, said demand for both fruits had surged primarily because consumers increasingly associate them with healthier lifestyles. The renewed consumer interest is encouraging farmers to look at these hardy indigenous species as commercial crops. Manila tamarind, a drought-tolerant horticultural tree, requires irrigation only during its establishment stage, making it suitable for rain-fed regions. The red-fleshed variety can fetch as much as ₹400 a kg. The revival has translated into attractive returns across the supply chain.

Weaving the Future of Viksit Bharat Inspired by the Prime Minister's Vision

A Grand Opening to a Global Textile Movement

The third edition of Bharat Tex commenced on a momentous note with its inauguration by Giriraj Singh, Union Minister of Textiles at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. Organised by the Bharat Tex Trade Federation (BTTF) with the support of the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India, the event marked the opening of the world's largest integrated textile value chain platform.

The inaugural ceremony was graced by Pabitra Margherita, Union Minister of State for Textiles and External Affairs; Neelam Shami Rao, Secretary, Ministry of Textiles along with Ministers and senior officials from partner States, international ministerial delegations, global buyers, industry



leaders, exporters, investors, and representatives from the global textile ecosystem.

Reflecting on Bharat Tex's growing international profile, the ceremony was also attended by Timur Gavaev, Minister of Agriculture, Russian Federation, Mark Patterson, Minister for Rural Communities and Associate Minister of Agriculture, New Zealand. Ministerial delegations from Sri Lanka also participated in the event, while industry and business delegations from the United States, Japan, Spain, United Kingdom, Portugal, Russia, South Africa, New Zealand, Germany, the UAE, Thailand, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka among others also participated.



"Bharat Tex is becoming a strong platform for engagement, collaboration and partnership for the policymakers, CEOs and industry leaders from across the world"

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister



"The textile industry possesses substantial potential for job creation. Furthermore, this sector accounts for a significant portion of international exports."
Giriraj Singh,
Union Minister of Textiles



"Serving as a cornerstone of our economy, the textile sector possesses the capacity to elevate the livelihoods of millions as it continues to expand."
Pabitra Margherita
Union Minister of State for Textiles and External Affairs



"The objective of Bharat Tex 2026 is to highlight the competitive strength of India's complete textile value chain, positioning the nation at the vanguard of the global textile sector."
Neelam Shami Rao
Secretary, Ministry of Textiles



"I am confident that India would become the global recycling hub for textiles and we intent to invest USD 500 million (approximately ₹4,800 crore) in textiles waste recycling, promoting circularity and create large scale employment opportunities."
Fatih Konukoglu
Chairman, RE&UP, Turkey



"In just three editions, Bharat Tex has emerged as one of the world's most significant textile platforms. By bringing together the entire textile value chain, it has created unparalleled opportunities for global brands, buyers, innovators, and manufacturers to connect, collaborate, and build the future together."
Padma Shri Dr. Rajinder Gupta,
MP, Rajya Sabha and Chairman Emeritus of Trident Group



"India is currently New Zealand's second largest market for wool – it is a key market for Kiwi wool growers and exporters and there is strong potential for further growth."
Mark Patterson
Minister for Rural Communities and Associate Minister of Agriculture, New Zealand



"Bharat Tex has emerged as a remarkable platform that brings together policymakers, industry leaders, designers, manufacturers, buyers, and innovators to collectively shape the future of Indian textiles."
Vaishali Shadangule
VAISHALI S



"My key takeaway from the Bharat Tex roundtable was one simple but p'owerful thought: India has reached a defining moment in its journey from being a supplier to becoming a creator of globally respected brands."
Rahul Mishra
AFEW Rahul Mishra



"Earlier, we used to go abroad to convince buyers to buy from us. At Bharat Tex, buyers are reaching out to us to book orders. This platform has given us significant global visibility."
Sundaramurthy
Ramraj Cotton, Tiruppur



States & Global Trade in Focus

Bharat Tex 2026 spotlighted state as India's textiles growth engine with dedicated investment led sessions by Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Punjab, Karnataka, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu showcasing their policy initiatives, textile ecosystems and manufacturing strengths.

Dr. Mohan Yadav, Chief Minister, Madhya Pradesh and Bhagwant Mann, Chief Minister, Punjab led a large delegation from their States and highlighted the policy landscape, world class industrial infrastructure, including reliable power supply and strong value chain capabilities.



Weaving Global Partnerships

Bharat Tex 2026 was a landmark in international textile collaboration, bringing together over 600 global speakers, industry leaders, CXOs, policymakers, and thought leaders from more than 20 countries, supported by a dedicated International Pavilion for cross-border engagement. Special bilateral sessions highlighted the India-US cotton partnership, India-New Zealand wool ecosystem, India-Russia Roundtable, India-UK FTA in action where trade, investments and collaborations were discussed at bilateral level, with clearly defined actionable for Indian Textiles Industry players. In addition, investment focussed sessions explored India's world class PM MITRA Parks and the policy incentives provided for foreign and domestic investors.



INSPIRED BY THE 5F VISION

reinforcing India's role in sustainability, innovation, and future ready manufacturing. In a time of shifting supply chains and expanding trade agreements, Bharat Tex 2026 offered a timely platform to co-create resilient textile value chains. From business centre to innovation engine, it stood as a symbol of India's textile revolution—where commerce met creativity, and tradition met technology.

Inspired by the Prime Minister's 5F vision—Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign— Bharat Tex has rapidly grown into the world's largest integrated textile expo, uniting the entire value chain. Launched in 2024, it has become a strategic platform for policy dialogue, trade partnerships, and technology collaboration across 110+ countries.

By blending traditional craftsmanship with advanced technical textiles, Bharat Tex is shaping the future of global trade while reinforcing India's role in sustainability, innovation, and future ready manufacturing. In a time of shifting supply chains and expanding trade agreements, Bharat Tex 2026 offered a timely platform to co-create resilient textile value chains. From business centre to innovation engine, it stood as a symbol of India's textile revolution—where commerce met creativity, and tradition met technology.

Glimpses of Bharat Tex 2026



Russian delegates at Bharat Tex 2026



International Buyer interacting with Exhibitor at Bharat Tex 2026



Premiere Vision to collaborate with BTTF to strengthen India-Europe market linkage



Global industry body - International Apparel Federation conducted their Board Meeting at Bharat Tex

Business Outcomes

₹14,300 Crore of textile
Investment Commitments with
30+ MoUs
100+ B2G/G2G Meetings

Knowledge Programme

100+ knowledge sessions
50+ partner agencies onboarded

From Business Hub to Innovation Engine

Bharat Tex 2026 has evolved from a global textile hub into India's largest innovation platform. Exhibition halls showcased sustainable fabrics, AI-powered matchmaking, and technical textiles for healthcare, defence, and agriculture. At the Sanrachna Pavilion, young innovators presented impactful ideas—protective garments for farmers, wound-care bandages, and insulated mattresses for soldiers—proving classrooms can drive change.

Scale & Numbers

6,000+ International Buyers

138 Countries Visited

94,000+ Trade Visitors

28,500+ B2B Meetings

20,000+

Textile Products on Display

1.6 million sq. ft.
of Exhibition Space

1,600+ Exhibitors

Intl. Exhibitors from 16 Countries

600+ Speakers from
20+ Countries

Spotlight on Sustainability

Bharat Tex 2026 drew strong global participation, with discussions centering on circularity, responsible sourcing, traceability and resource efficiency. At Bharat Tex 2026, a dedicated Eco-Stitch Sustainability & Circularity Hub was set-up underscoring its role in advancing India's leadership in sustainable, circular and globally competitive textile and apparel manufacturing. More than 30 knowledge sessions were organized by multilateral bodies and international think tanks focusing on sustainability, circularity and closed loop manufacturing.



State Participation

8 Sponsor States

9 Exhibitor States/UTs

Together Towards Viksit Bharat

We are honoured to be part of this transformative journey, and grateful for the opportunity to advance the vision of Viksit Bharat—one thread at a time.

GLOBAL TEXTILE EXPO



TEXTILES | FASHION | SUSTAINABILITY



New Delhi: The Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) on Friday announced the launch of the E-Commerce Council of India (ECCI), a national platform which will focus on advancing India's \$120 billion digital commerce ecosystem through collaborative engagement between industry, government and other key stakeholders. It said that this initiative brings together leading digital commerce companies like Amazon, Flipkart, Swiggy, Eternal, Indiamart, MakeMyTrip, Ixigo, Uber, Rapido, Shiprocket, Transport Corporation of India Limited (TCIL), eBay, Meesho and Tata 1Mg. IMAI said that the council will serve as a collaborative platform for stakeholders to engage with policymakers and develop best practices. **OUR BUREAU**

“We have cut the capacity only for June, July and August. From September onwards, most of the flights are already on sale,” he said.

Besides, Aggarwal said the continuing closure of Pakistan’s airspace remains the biggest operational challenge for the airline, although the reopening of Iranian and Iraqi airspace would provide significant re-



of aircraft shortages arising from the airline's ongoing fleet retrofit programme.

Aggarwal added that Air India has not altered its pricing structure, noting that the airline only determines fare buckets while actual ticket prices are determined by market demand and supply.

Memory chips drove up smartphone prices across al-



“As most Chinese brands are heavily exposed to the entry- and mid-tier segments, their overall market share fell to its lowest level for a second calendar quarter

Meanwhile, smartphone financing accounted for over 50 per cent of mainline smartphone sales in India. MediaTek continued to lead India's smartphone chipset market with a 49 per cent shipment share while Google emerged as the fastest-growing smartphone brand in the ultra-premium segment in Q2, posting 68 per cent annual growth.

In June alone, domestic gross box office collections stood at ₹1,038 crore, including projected future collections of June releases still running in theatres. Four out

While there was a growth in the number of films that

The record for highest annual footfalls post-pandemic is held by 2023, at 94.3 crore. With several big-ticket films lined up, the report noted that 100 crore footfalls cumulatively in 2026 seems achievable.

If Tanishq roped in Sachin Tendulkar to call for jewellery purchases through old gold exchange, and did an ad blitzkrieg, then Joyalukkas has taken an interesting tack. It is running an aggressive “Gold selling is better than gold pledging” campaign right now in multiple languages, urging customers to sell old jewellery instead of taking out expensive



Joy Alukkas, Chairman and Managing Director of the Joyalukkas Group, told *businessline* that gold had always been an integral part of every family's legacy, and many customers possess jewellery that is no longer worn as it is not aligned with current fashions. Yet, they

Participants endorsed the release of a white paper outlining recommendations to strengthen the country's CSR ecosystem through the SSE and accelerate progress towards a *Viksit Bharat*.

